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WOMEN'S POLITICAL PARTICIPATION AND LEADERSHIP FINAL REPORT

Nigeria Assessment

October 2023

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ACRONYMS

CSO	Civil Society Organization
DRG-LER	Democracy, Human Rights, and Governance Learning, Evaluation, and Research
FGD	Focus Group Discussion
KII	Key Informant Interview
WPPL	Women's Political Participation and Leadership
USAID	United States Agency for International Development
INEC	Independent National Electoral Commission
NASS	National Assembly
NWC	National Working Committee
APC	All Progressive Congress
PDP	Peoples Democratic Party
APGA	All Progressive Grand Alliance
SDP	Social Democratic Party
YPP	Young Progressive Party
LP	Labour Party
NNPP	New Nigeria People's Party
NAWOJ	Nigerian Association of Women Journalist
ADC	African Democratic Congress
VAWP	Violence Against Women in Politics
GBV	Gender-Based Violence

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Women in Nigeria remain woefully underrepresented at all levels of government and faced both structural and societal barriers to fully and meaningfully participate in the country's most recent elections in 2023. Already ranked the lowest in Africa for the number of women in political office, the number of women elected has declined since 2015. While the government has taken symbolic steps to promote affirmative action, such as calling for a 35 percent gender quota in elected and appointed office—without a legislative mandate with real enforcement mechanisms, women's representation is likely to stagnate due to deeply ingrained cultural and religious interpretations which severely hinder women's ability and opportunities to participate in public and political life.

Previously rejected calls for constitutional reforms—if revived—offer a transformative opportunity, now that general elections are complete. From creating 111 additional reserved seats for women, to instituting a 35 percent quota for women in leadership roles in political parties, this package of reforms, broadly supported by Nigerian women's organizations, would serve as a powerful foundation to tackle systemic inequalities and practices that disadvantage women. Although most men still lack an understanding of what barriers women face in politics and how those barriers should be overcome, traditional leaders and the media could open pathways for more progressive ideas about women's participation in politics and gender equality in general.

This study investigates the barriers and opportunities to expand women's participation and leadership in the political landscape in Nigeria. It uses the United States Agency for International Development's (USAID's) Women's Political Participation and Leadership (WPPL) Assessment Framework to document women's access to and power in politics along sociocultural, institutional, and individual dimensions. The report can be used by the relevant stakeholders to identify priority areas where their investments in programs and initiatives to support WPPL are likely to have the greatest and most meaningful impact.

BARRIERS AND OPPORTUNITIES TO WPPL

Below is a summary of barriers and opportunities to WPPL in Nigeria, further detailed in the report.

BARRIERS TO WPPL

- Prevailing gender norms and stereotypes, driven by patriarchal systems informed by conservative religious interpretations, shape the ability of women to participate in public and political life, and vary considerably across the country's diverse geographic, religious and economic strata.
- There is no legal framework to meaningfully promote women's political participation, or provide protections against rampant violence against them in the personal, public, and political spaces.
- Political parties lack internal democracy, meaning that the leaders of political parties, who are mostly men, often make decisions behind closed doors and intentionally exclude women members, making it difficult for women party members to be part of that process.
- Violence against women in politics (VAWP) often comes from men in their own parties feeling threatened if women become too popular and attempting to undermine their leadership.
- Political parties do not provide equal resources to women candidates or leaders, and this distribution often depends on relationships with party leaders.

- Electoral authorities are not delivering on their mandate to provide oversight of key electoral processes including party primaries and campaign financing, allowing opaque processes to favor male gatekeepers.
- The media often reproduces false narratives about women leaders that are promoted on social media.
- Because women still do the majority of caregiving and are still expected to adhere to traditional gender roles, they have less time than men to participate in politics.
- Men do not believe it is their responsibility to change a violent and patriarchal political environment; instead, they believe it is women's responsibility to be better "prepared."
- Women often lack the necessary resources to participate in politics as party leaders, candidates, and elected officials.
- Women sometimes lack the campaign skills to run successful campaigns and may not fully understand their rights to counter acts of violence perpetrated by members of their own parties against them.
- Because of pervasive sexism and conservative religious interpretations, women in Northern Nigeria are still underrepresented and face stronger barriers accessing politics due to compounding discrimination.

OPPORTUNITIES FOR WPPL

- The legal framework around women's political participation could be revisited now that national elections are completed and there is a reasonable timeframe to manage a serious legislative reform process.
- The INEC's gender policy could be used by election authorities to incentivize party reforms in the inter-election period.
- Women's civil society is strong and has successfully come together and advocated for important gains for women's rights.
- Primary and secondary schools provide an important space for girls and boys to begin engaging in politics, though these institutions are not without some similar challenges to political parties. In addition, higher education is more accessible for women than ever before.
- There is openness amongst some traditional and religious leaders on the benefits of women's participation and leadership and the demerits of women's exclusion from political spaces.

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ACTION

Below is a summary of the recommendations for action, which are detailed in the report.

SOCIO-CULTURAL FACTORS

- Support gender transformative education programs to change attitudes and behaviors.
- Shift harmful cultural views and behavior by engaging men gatekeepers and allies.
- Support WPPL public information campaigns, rooted in cultural values, that name and take on patriarchal behavior. Partner with leaders of religious organizations to show how religious views and gender equality can and should coexist.
- Training for diverse groups of media workers (e.g., regional/national, print, television, digital) to cover WPPL, VAWP, and Gender Based Violence (GBV).

INSTITUTIONAL FACTORS

- Regroup and reignite advocacy efforts for passage of gender bills.
- INEC acts on existing authority, in partnership with Civil Society Organizations (CSOs), to advocate for gender equality in political parties.
- Media should build trust with, and promote women candidates.

INDIVIDUAL FACTORS

- There exists a cohort of young leaders across all sectors that key donors and implementing partners, including the USAID, have engaged and built their leadership capacities. This cohort of leaders can be supported to advance their leadership skills.
- Consistent and proactive capacity building of women party members.
- Design and implement a mentorship program for women politicians.
- Provide programs that support women's access to and control over financial resources.

INTRODUCTION

ASSESSMENT OBJECTIVES

Under the Democracy, Human Rights, and Governance Learning, Evaluation, and Research (DRG-LER) II activity, USAID tasked Cloudburst Group with implementing three country-level WPPL assessments, based on the latest iteration of the WPPL Assessment Framework. The WPPL Assessment Framework aims to identify key barriers and opportunities to advance WPPL at the individual, socio-cultural, and structural levels. This report discusses the results of the Nigeria WPPL Assessment. These results are intended to guide program strategies, activity design, and allocation of resources aimed at advancing WPPL in Nigeria, as well as guide the work of other stakeholders working on gender and democracy in Nigeria.

COUNTRY BACKGROUND

POLITICAL ECONOMY ANALYSIS OF WOMEN POLITICAL PARTICIPATION

Women in Nigeria remain woefully underrepresented at all levels of government and faced both structural and societal barriers to fully and meaningfully participate in the country's most recent elections in 2023. Already ranked the lowest in Africa for the number of women in political office, the number of women elected has declined since 2015; in 2023, women represented less than 10 percent of presidential and National Assembly (NASS) candidates, a drop from 12 percent in 2019.¹ The national leadership of the only party that nominated a women presidential candidate for the 2023 elections - the Allied People's Movement (APM) - withdrew its support for her candidature just a week before the election, endorsing another man presidential candidate.

In early 2022, the NASS rejected five constitutional reform bills aimed at promoting women's rights and political empowerment. One proposed reform would have created 111 additional reserved seats for women, while another would have instituted a 35 percent quota for women in leadership roles in political parties. The preponderance of money in political campaigns in Nigeria creates significant disadvantages for women candidates who typically lack the funds to effectively compete against their male counterparts. In addition, women aspirants were frequently the targets of violence, especially cyberbullying, sexual harassment and assault, and other forms of physical violence, which potentially derailed their campaigns or prevented them from running for office entirely.

LEGAL FRAMEWORK

The constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria² provides the framework that guarantees women's rights to political participation, alongside all other citizens. Specifically, Section 17 (1) and (2a) stress that, 'the State social order is founded on ideals of freedom, equality, and justice and that every citizen shall have equality of rights, obligations, and opportunities before the Law.' However, other sections of the Constitution do not hold up equal rights for women (i.e., conveying citizenship through marriage).

¹ NDI/IRI Election Observation Mission. Preliminary Statement on Nigeria's 2023 Presidential and Legislative Elections. February, 2023. <https://www.ndi.org/publications/ndi-iri-election-observation-mission-nigeria-s-2023-presidential-legislative-elections>

² <https://nicn.gov.ng/publication/gazette.pdf>

In 2006, the National Gender Policy was put forth as a set of minimum standards expected of the Nigerian government to meet its mandate for gender equality, good governance, and accountability. Included amongst its provisions was a 35 percent gender quota for elected and appointed office. However, corresponding legislation to mandate this through the election code and political parties law have yet to be adopted. A study by the Policy and Legal Advocacy Center³ characterized the implementation of an electoral gender system in Nigeria as ‘non-existent.’

Legislators have consistently resisted implementing gender equality measures such as binding quotas. Several bills have been rejected on the grounds that they compromise traditional Christian or Islamic beliefs.⁴ In 2022, five key bills that had the potential to bolster women’s equal rights and promote their participation and representation in politics were also rejected by the NASS.⁵ These include (i) the citizenship bill aimed at providing avenues for citizenship for foreign spouses of Nigerian women, (ii) the affirmative action bill aimed at ensuring that at least 35 percent of political party administration and appointed positions are women, (iii) the indigenship bill which should allow for a woman to be an indigene of her husband’s state and be eligible to run for that state’s public offices after five years of living there and finally, (iv) the quota bill which ensures that women constitute at least 35 percent of federal and state executive councils or ministerial and commissioner positions, (v) the reserved seat bill aimed at creating a total of 111 additional reserved seats for women at the NASS. Though the NASS agreed to reconsider the first three out of these five bills following the outbreak of protests among women groups after the rejection of the five gender bills, nothing has been passed to date.

WOMEN’S STATUS

Nigeria ranks 168⁶ on the global gender inequality index. Women in Nigeria experience violence in the form of rape, physical and psychological abuse, and intimidation, amongst other forms of violence, as they struggle for social, political and economic rights.⁷ According to the 2018 Nigeria Demographic and Health Survey (NDHS), 31 percent of women aged 15 to 49 have encountered some type of physical violence since they turned 15.⁸

Nigeria accounts for more than one in five out-of-school children anywhere in the world. Although primary education is officially free and compulsory, only 67 percent of eligible children take up a place in primary school. In the North East of Nigeria, only 41 percent of eligible girls receive a primary education, and only 47 percent in the North West.⁹ Social attitudes can negatively impact education rates, especially in northern Nigeria. In North Eastern and North Western states, 29 percent and 35 percent of Muslim children, respectively, attend Qur’anic education, which does not include basic education skills such as literacy and numeracy. These children are officially considered out-of-school by the Government.

³ Policy and Legal Advocacy Centre (PLAC) (2018) Women’s political representation in Nigeria: why progress is slow and what can be done to fast-track it. Available at: www.placng.org

⁴ [Towards overcoming gender challenges in community participation — Appointments — The Guardian Nigeria News – Nigeria and World News](#)

⁵ <https://www.iri.org/news/wdn-bolsters-nigerian-womens-political-leadership-in-the-wake-of-legislative-disappointment/>

⁶ <https://evaw-global-database.unwomen.org/en/countries/africa/nigeria?pageNumber=3#6>

⁷ Mshelia, I. H., (2021) Gender Based Violence and Violence against Women in Nigeria: A Sociological Analysis International Journal of Research and Innovation in Social Science (IJRISS) |Volume V, Issue VIII, Page 674

⁸ <https://dhsprogram.com/pubs/pdf/SR264/SR264.pdf>

⁹ UNICEF Nigeria. <https://www.unicef.org/nigeria/situation-women-and-children-nigeria>

At 27 percent, the prevalence of female genital mutilation/cutting (FGM/C) among girls and women aged 15-49 years is lower than in many countries where the practice is carried out, but Nigeria still has the third highest absolute number of women and girls (19.9 million) who have undergone FGM/C worldwide.¹⁰

Despite these barriers, Nigerian women continue to record breakthroughs and international recognition in all sectors and leadership. Interestingly, the strength of women leadership varies by region with more women from the North East recording near victories in the gubernatorial elections, more women deputy governors in the South Western part of the country, and more women senators and legislators from the South.

METHODOLOGY

The purpose of the assessment is to understand the current state of WPPL and pinpoint challenges and opportunities for advancing WPPL in Nigeria. The assessment seeks to answer the following four questions:

- Are women politically engaged as citizens, in any of a wide range of possible political roles?
- Do women exercise political agency and influence as citizens?
- Do women serve as political leaders, whether in elected or non-elected roles?
- Do women exercise political agency and influence as political leaders?

While global indicators of WPPL largely focus on the numbers of women in elected and appointed political positions, this assessment methodology expands the definition of WPPL in two key ways. First, it divides this concept into two interrelated, yet distinct, components: **political participation**, referring to activities women can engage in as citizens, and **political leadership**, referring to activities women can engage in as elected and non-elected political representatives. Second, it recognizes that simply being granted political rights is not the same as exercising those rights to the fullest extent. A complete assessment of WPPL must, therefore, look at both **access**, women's ability to take part in the political process, and **power**, women's voice and agency as political actors.

Three interacting sets of factors shape opportunities for women to participate substantively in every aspect of political life. **Socio-cultural factors** involve assumptions about appropriate norms and practices, shaping social expectations as well as personal attitudes and behaviors. They include gender stereotypes, prevailing views on gender roles, and cultural and religious ideas about gender equality. **Institutional factors** structure the political environment, establishing the formal and informal rules and systems in which political actors operate. They include the electoral system, the political party system, and the broader political and legal context. **Individual factors** refer to considerations shaping individual women's decisions and abilities to participate in politics. These include levels of political ambition, as well as resources and support, for their political engagement.

Understanding these factors as an “ecosystem” emphasizes how they work together and inform one another to create environments supporting or undermining WPPL. Focusing only on one set of factors to the exclusion of the others is likely to lead to misinterpretations of the current situation—and, in turn, to the adoption of only partially effective solutions to expand WPPL. In

¹⁰ Ibid.

contrast, an ecosystem approach suggests the need to consider more holistic strategies, combining a focus on norm change, institutional reforms, and individual shifts in thinking. Because gender-based violence and VAWP cuts across all these factors, findings about violence are integrated throughout these sections.

The WPPL Assessment has three parts: Part I involves mapping the current state of WPPL; Part II entails analyzing barriers and opportunities to WPPL; and Part III involves transitioning from the research to the writing of the final report and making evidence-based recommendations.

The assessment employed four tools: a desk review, a politician survey with elected and non-elected politicians, Key Informant Interviews (KIIs), and Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) with diverse stakeholder groups. These tools provide quantitative and qualitative sources of evidence to understand better the current situation as well as barriers and opportunities for advancing WPPL, engaging a wide range of stakeholders and diverse groups of women and men.

The assessment findings discussed in this report are derived from a desk review of relevant literature and USAID documents, a survey completed by 116 politicians unevenly spread across the six geopolitical¹¹ zones in Nigeria, 29 KIIs, and 11 FGDs with men and women politicians, CSOs, and media in Abuja, Akwa Ibom, and Gombe States. The Nigeria Assessment Team conducted in-country data collection for this assessment between September 4 and 22, 2023 (further information about data sources is included in Annex B).

LIMITATIONS

The findings from this research are presented in light of the following limitations. The first noticeable limitation is the small sample size across both the quantitative and qualitative aspects of the research. While the researchers were able to identify important trends in the findings that informed recommendations, a larger response rate would have allowed for a more nuanced analysis of subgroups across geography, gender, and disability, amongst others. The second limitation concerns the time allocated for the fieldwork, which restricted the number of states the researchers could visit, leading to the prioritization of states where the USAID had program interests. A final limitation centers around the challenge of reaching elected politicians, especially men, who indicated interest but were erratic to confirm their attendance in KIIs.

¹¹ The six geo political zones in Nigeria are the North West, North East, North Central, South West, South East and South South.

CURRENT STATE OF WPPL

WOMEN'S POLITICAL PARTICIPATION

The section below describes the current state of WPPL in Nigeria across the different areas of the WPPL spectrum, which includes access to and power in participation and access to and power in leadership. Political participation refers to all conventional and unconventional activities through which citizens can engage both individually or collectively to influence political decision-making or solve collective problems. Common forms of political participation include voting, engaging in political discussions, contacting elected officials, attending political rallies and campaign events, signing petitions, protesting, and joining political parties. Given women's long-standing exclusion from and underrepresentation in more formal political roles, civil society has long been an important space for women's political engagement in Nigeria, permitting them to voice opinions on political issues despite their lack of representation in elected circles. Such activities may include membership in formal CSOs operating at the grassroots to national levels. This section looks at Nigerian women's access to participation and the levels of influence they are able to exert in leadership positions.

WOMEN AS VOTERS

During the 2023 general elections, the Nigerian Independent National Electoral Commission (INEC) certified 47.5 percent of 93,469,008 of registered voters were women. High voter registration did not translate to similar rates of turnout—only 25.7 percent of registered voters participated in the polls. The INEC does not issue disaggregated voter information, making it a challenge to determine the actual levels of participation of women, or other groups of registered voters.¹²

Despite this lack of data from election authorities on turnout rates, women are seen as an important voting bloc to mobilize. Women's power to mobilize voters is also recognized and harnessed by political parties, who have created specific woman leader positions within the structure of political parties to enhance get-out-the-vote (GOTV) efforts. These women leaders mobilize women and women groups to participate in elections, mostly by attending political campaigns and voting for anointed candidates.

"In Kano State, we have studied that to win elections you must mainstream women because they can come in large numbers. We look for active women and give them positions. If you look at Kano elections, you will see massive women turnout and they will stay from morning till night. You cannot have effective mobilization without putting women in leadership." —Man politician

WOMEN IN CIVIL SOCIETY

Civil society is the most important space where women are able to organize, raise their concerns and build leadership capacity to participate in politics in Nigeria. Women's prominence in civil society was validated by all respondent groups in this research, including men and women. Civil society focus group participants acknowledged that women are more active and occupy leadership positions in CSOs that have a gender focus, such as improving WPPL, and are less

¹² Koni Hoffman, Leena. "Nigeria's election results put disenfranchisement in spotlight." March, 2023. <https://www.chathamhouse.org/2023/03/nigerias-election-results-put-disenfranchisement-spotlight>

visible as leaders in organizations focused on other issues. Nigerian women can be found in several leadership positions of notable organizations that engage in governance and electoral processes.

“I will say that women are very active in the civil society space. For instance, I will start from the twenty-two states where we cover; the women do most of the important things that get the civil society moving.” Woman CSO member

Women’s participation in CSOs transcends age, with intergenerational learning and networking. Women who experience disabilities are also actively advocating for the rights of women and Persons with Disabilities (PWD). There is a marked difference in the level of women’s participation in CSOs between the South and the North. Culture, religion, and lower levels of education influence women’s reduced participation in CSOs in Northern Nigeria.

Women CSOs coming together to achieve a common goal increases their power in participation. Examples of these groups include Womanifesto, a group of 335 women Executive Directors and leaders of gender-based CSOs who pushed for the passage of the five gender bills. At the national and federal level, there are several efforts targeted at changing cultural norms, training and capacity building, mentoring, monitoring elections, and advocating for affirmative actions from the Nigerian government.¹³ Donors and international organizations also fund several programs to improve women’s political participation and reduce the incidence of VAWP. For example, before the 2023 elections, UN Women, in collaboration with INEC, organized a workshop on preventing and mitigating violence against women with security agencies.¹⁴ The FCDO Partnerships to Engage, Reform and Learn (PERL) also had a Community of Practice of women in Governance where they mentored and motivated women politicians to engage better in politics.¹⁵

WOMEN IN POLITICAL PARTIES

All political parties¹⁶ included in this research have robust gender inclusion and empowerment statements, in their manifestos and party guidelines and constitutions. However, implementation is suboptimal. Findings from this research show that women rarely occupy positions of influence. For example, none of the political parties included in this research currently has or have ever had a woman occupying the position of chairman or deputy chairman. At the leadership level, the woman leader position responsible for mobilizing voters is the sole consistent opportunity. In cases where women occupy other positions, it is done in a tokenistic manner rather than from a point of need. In general, women are usually urged to join political parties as members and participate in political activities, but when it comes to being elected or appointed to leadership positions, the sentiment that leadership roles cannot be held by women prevails.

“What I have noticed personally is that, while women occupy leadership positions mainly as women leaders or members of National Executive Committee, there’s a

¹³ https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/5d430c8eed915d09ddb354a/596_Nigerian_Women_Governance.pdf

¹⁴ <https://www.inecnigeria.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/02/INEC-UN-WOMEN-CONDUCT-WORKSHOP-FOR-SECURITY-AGENCIES-ON-PREVENTION-AND-MITIGATION-OF-VIOLENCE-AGAINST-WOMEN-IN-ELECTIONS.pdf>

¹⁵ http://cdn-odi-production.s3-website-eu-west-1.amazonaws.com/media/documents/Flagship_UK_Governance_Programming_in_Nigeria_final.pdf

¹⁶ For this assessment, the following eight political parties with representation at the federal level were included: Africa Democratic Party (ADC), All Progressives Congress (APC), All Progressive Grand Alliance (APGA), Labour Party (LP), New Nigeria People’s Party (NNPP), People’s Democratic Party (PDP), Social Democratic Party (SDP), and Young Progressive Party (YPP).

limit to their influence, to how much they can deploy the power of that position which they occupy, that's within the political party.” —Man CSO member

“Most times you see that the positions that are given to females are persons with disabilities in political parties, are just so that they serve as mobilizers for them not to have some sort of authority to exercise the same rule that male counterparts in similar positions will exercise.” — Man CSO member

No Nigerian political parties currently have affirmative action mechanisms, such as quotas, in place. Through the desk review and field research, the following trends were observed.

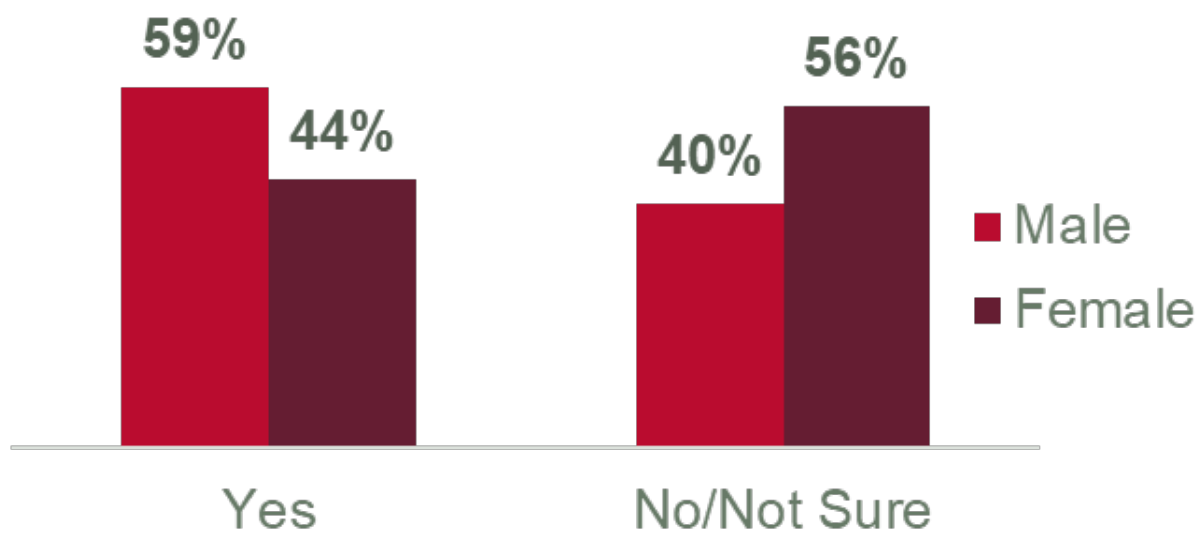
- Stronger and more established political parties have few women occupying positions of leadership within the Executive and National Working Committees (NWC).
- Newer and growing political parties are more open to women’s participation, and women occupy key positions besides that of the woman leader.
- Across all political parties, the woman leader position is a key position reserved for women to endear women to the party and mobilize women during campaigns and elections. However, younger and growing political parties extend the role of the woman leader to include mentorship and encouraging women to run for elections.

Fewer women register to be members of political parties than their male counterparts. While the researchers could not access data on political party membership, discussions with key informants revealed that even though women participate in campaigns and ceremonial political party activities such as inaugurations, they do not register to be members at the same rate as the men.

“I think that more men join political parties than women get up to join political parties. They will rather join village meetings, church associations, thrift and loan cooperatives.” —Woman Politician

Findings from the politician survey showed that men and women had different opinions when it comes to women’s opportunity to influence political debates. More men agreed that men and women had equal voices and influence in political debates while more women held an opposing view.

Figure 1. Do men and women have equal voices and influence in political debates in Nigeria?

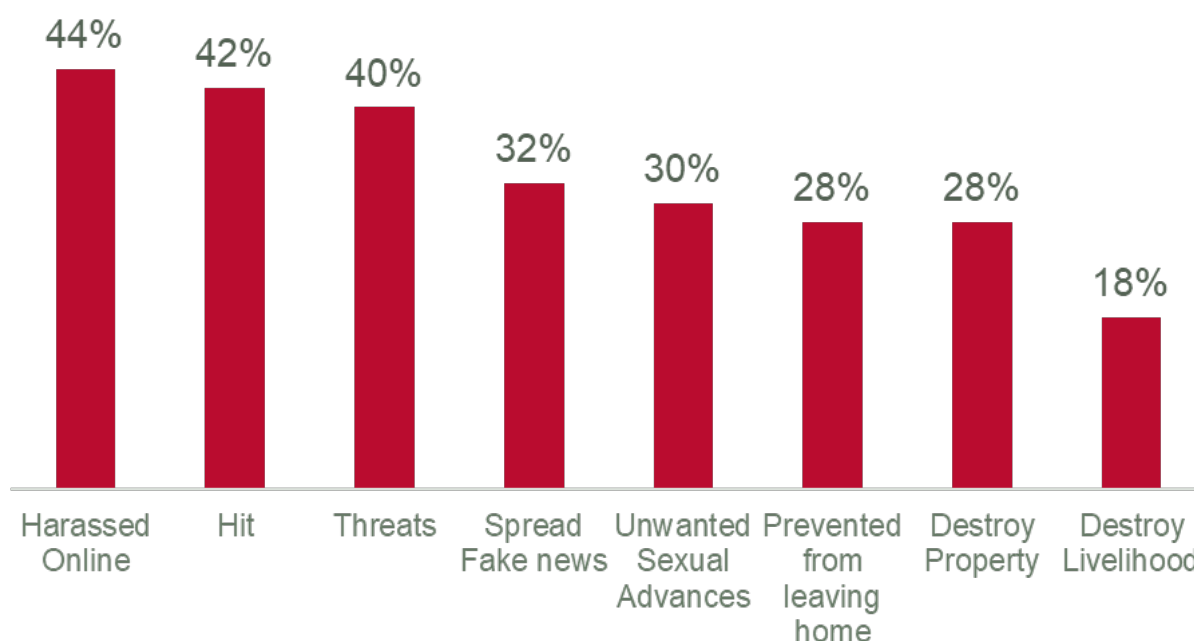


VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN IN POLITICS

According to the 2018 Nigeria Demographic and Health Survey (NDHS), 31 percent of women aged 15 to 49 have encountered some type of physical violence since they turned 15.¹⁷ Nigeria ranks 168¹⁸ on the global gender inequality index. Women in Nigeria experience violence in the form of rape, physical and psychological abuse, and intimidation, amongst other forms of violence, as they struggle for social, political and economic rights.¹⁹ Violence against women active in political life is a form of gender-based violence that manifests physically, psychologically, and sexually, both in-person and online and this issue continues to draw the attention of global actors. In March 2022, top UN officials gathered with the government and civil society to draw attention to the issue of VAWP. In her address, the head of the UN Women mentioned some of the negative effects of VAWP, which included silencing women, rendering them invisible, and pushing them out of the public space.

From the politician survey, the most frequent form of VAWP was online harassment and verbal attacks experienced by 44 percent of women respondents.

Figure 2. Types of violence experienced by women in politics



In the buildup to the 2023 elections, several cases on violence against women were recorded. Most notable are the violent murder of a former Peoples Democratic Party (PDP) leader in Abia state, who was among four people killed in Ohafia Local Government Area (LGA) in March 2022.²⁰ In a separate instance, a Labour Party (LP) leader in Kaura LGA of Kaduna state was murdered

¹⁷ <https://dhsprogram.com/pubs/pdf/SR264/SR264.pdf>

¹⁸ <https://evaw-global-database.unwomen.org/en/countries/africa/nigeria?pageNumber=3#6>

¹⁹ Mshelia, I. H., (2021) Gender Based Violence and Violence against Women in Nigeria: A Sociological Analysis International Journal of Research and Innovation in Social Science (IJRISS) |Volume V, Issue VIII, Page 674

²⁰ [Gunmen kill ex-PDP women leader, daughter, two others in Abia - Punch Newspapers \(punchng.com\)](https://punchng.com/gunmen-kill-ex-pdp-women-leader-daughter-two-others-in-abia/)

in November 2023 after gunmen raided her house.²¹ This prompted UN Women and others to launch an advocacy campaign for the prevention of electoral violence against women and girls.²² While gender-disaggregated data on the total number of cases of electoral violence in the 2023 elections is not readily available, a survey by KIMPACT²³ estimated a total of 238 violent incidents on election day; 98 cases recorded on the presidential and NASS elections, and 140 cases recorded during the gubernatorial and SHoA elections with a cumulative total of 952 victims and 24 fatalities.

Election monitors²⁴ indicated that violence, intimidation, and sexual harassment of women during elections is a common occurrence and is used to intimidate women voters and candidates. Monitors have gone on to list the key perpetrators as party operatives, agents and members, and members of the security services.

Beyond physical violence, women also have to go through psychological violence, which includes threats, character assassination, stalking, online abuse, and gender-based hate speech. Other forms of violence include economic violence, which includes property theft and damage, and intentional abuse of women's rights by their husbands or fathers who force them to vote for candidates they do not want to vote for, or keep them from voting altogether. There have also been reported cases of violence by association where women are the secondary victims of election-related violence as a result of their family relationships and social affiliations, such as being the wife, mother, or daughter of a political candidate.²⁵

Women CSO members who participated in this study reported regularly facing psychological violence that actively prevented them from speaking, and their voices from being heard.

"I have had a share of my own experience, we have gone to court and we see ourselves being trolled, we have handled cases such as preventing us from accessing a venue, there are a lot of exposure violence. For Women rights defenders, the type of violence is emotional." —WPPL Expert

Women in leadership positions have also been known to perpetrate violence, especially to subordinates and younger politicians, by making the space toxic for them or stunting their political growth to the point that they drop their political ambitions or move to other political parties. While no woman candidate is free from violence, certain women are more likely to be targeted. These include: (i) Women who are running for the first time and are less likely to have security, financial, and social capital necessary to win elections. These women may also face economic violence, where they are forced to step down by another party member who has more money. (ii) Women who are single/unmarried or widowed, often face psychological violence which centered around name calling and tagging them promiscuous. (iii) Women who are popular and are gaining traction in their campaigns and political careers, (iv) Women who are contesting for an opposition political party, most especially at the community level, (v) Women who are from a minority ethnic group within a state and women who experience disability. Part of the psychological violence women

²¹ [How gunmen killed Labour Party LGA women leader in Kaduna - Vanguard News \(vanguardngr.com\)](https://www.vanguardngr.com/2023/11/20/how-gunmen-killed-labour-party-lga-women-leader-in-kaduna/)

²² <https://von.gov.ng/united-nations-advocates-prevention-of-violence-against-women/>

²³ <https://www.kdi.org.ng/the-quest-for-peaceful-election/>

²⁴ NDI/IRI Election Observation Mission. Preliminary Statement on Nigeria's 2023 Presidential and Legislative Elections. February, 2023. <https://www.ndi.org/publications/ndiiri-election-observation-mission-nigeria-s-2023-presidential-legislative-elections>

²⁵ Safir A. Z., and Alam M. (2015). The 2015 Nigeria Elections and Violence against women in politics. <https://giwps.georgetown.edu/wp-content/uploads/2017/10/Special-Report-Nigeria-2.pdf>

candidates experience is the extension of violence to their family and close supporters. This form of violence is applied to get the women to drop their political ambitions.

“The types of women to be targeted are the ones that stand to be like a threat to the victory of the opponent, these are women who have made names in the political environment even in their political parties.” —Party Leader

The incidence of violence against women politicians also varies, depending on region, with more cases of violence recorded in the North.

“The magnitude of this kind of issue depends on which region you are coming from. We don’t have similar cases in the South-West where they are more liberal but the North-West in particular is still tight for women.” —Woman media member

Experiencing these acts of violence negatively affects women's willingness and motivation to run for elections. While women candidates are more exposed to, and experience violence in the course of their activities, research findings show that women political leaders are less prone to experiencing acts of violence. Once they assume leadership positions, their portfolios confer on them additional security and they are also able to afford housing in more secured areas. Women leaders are more likely to experience emotional and psychological violence, character attacks, mostly perpetrated online by strangers. The experience is slightly better for women appointed leaders because they always have the backing and support of their patrons who are in power and who conferred them with the appointment. However, they are still not free from internal dynamics.

“For women leaders, because they are leaders, they have some security around them, so I don’t think it is the same experience for them.” —Party Leader

WOMEN’S POLITICAL LEADERSHIP

Access to and power in leadership for elected women politicians in Nigeria has been a complex and evolving issue. Nigeria, like many countries, has struggled with gender disparities in political representation for years.

Women’s access to leadership in Nigeria is still very low, and trending in a concerning direction. For example, in the current cohort of NASS members, women only make up 4.2 percent²⁶, a record low since 1999. Even though Nigeria committed to implementing a 35 percent quota for women, this quota has not translated into increased access to leadership among women. Concerningly, some politicians—women and men—felt that implementing the quota system was unconstitutional.

“Political parties often intentionally disregard the affirmative action quota for women's inclusion in politics. Even when they attempt to become more inclusive, there is still a lack of quality representation of women. Personally, I think this quota system isn’t working.” —Woman politician

For other respondents, the quota system has had limited impact and has only been useful in raising awareness of the need and benefit of women’s political participation.

‘I think the gender quota has had some impact, perhaps not as significant as we expected. Without the gender policy and 35% affirmative action, we would be

²⁶ Policy and Legal Advocacy Center (PLAC) 2023. Worrying Numbers for Women in the 10th National Assembly, NASS. [Worrying Numbers for Women in 10th NASS – PLAC Legist \(placng.org\)](https://www.placng.org/Worrying-Numbers-for-Women-in-10th-NASS)

worse off. With the benchmark, political parties have added in to their constitutions and legal documents on women participation. The issue now lies in whether they are implementing it or not.” —WPPL expert

The quota system has had almost no impact on the number of women in appointed positions. Under the current administration, only nine (20 percent)²⁷ women were appointed as ministers out of 45, a far cry from the affirmed 35 percent quota for women as contained in the 2006 gender policy. Most survey respondents were of the opinion that women’s access to leadership both in elected and appointed positions is low, while some respondents agreed that all women can potentially benefit from quotas, in theory, only certain types of women benefit in practice.

“For a woman to benefit from quotas It depends on how connected she is or how strong her sponsor is in providing support, or whether they come from political dynasties or they are married into political families.” —WPPL expert

²⁷ <https://www.bbc.com/pidgin/tori-66343405>

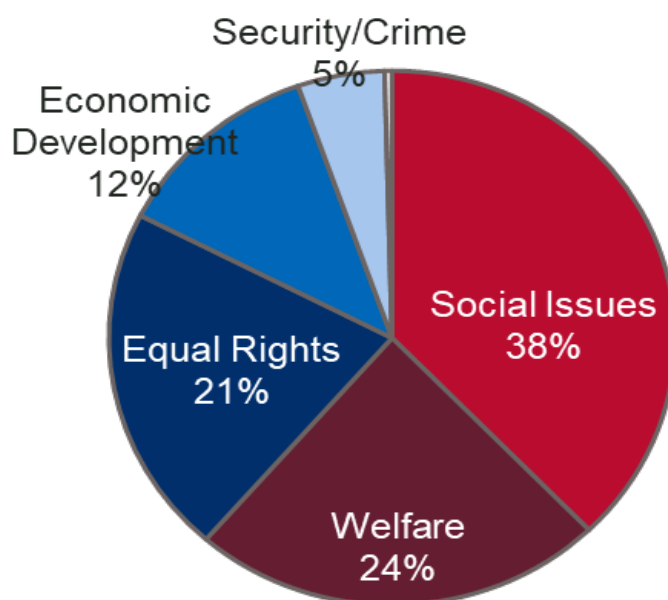
“If you take a closer look at some of the women that made it this time around, they are either wives of famous politicians or linked to their fathers or somebody. Most of them did not come on the merit but because they have connections from their husbands of which some are former governors, or former senators, and the negotiations are at that level.”— Woman media member

Some respondents mentioned that women are usually unable to exercise power even when they are in leadership positions and that their involvement is mostly seen as tokenistic.

“I was made Vice Chairman of presidential committee, but since I was given that position, the chairman has never had any meeting with me. I haven’t been informed about the committee budget by the chairman. I just heard from other sources but he never called me to discuss and plan ways forward but he goes for meetings regularly. They do not take women seriously.”—Woman politician

Respondents of the politician survey highlighted the type of issues women are given responsibility for in leadership. Findings show that women are rarely given opportunities to contribute to economic or security issues, and most often relegated to social issues which are considered their appropriate area for engagement.

Figure 3. Types of issues women are given responsibility for in leadership



Few women are able to break the norm and demonstrate power in leadership, especially in appointed positions where these women are backed by strong patrons and have demonstrated excellence in their fields.

WOMEN IN ELECTED OFFICE

In the 2023 general elections, only three women (2.7 percent) were elected to the Senate, and 17 women (4.7 percent) to the House of Representatives. These figures are far below the global

average of 26.1 percent of women in parliament.²⁸ Nigeria ranks among the lowest countries globally in terms of women's participation in leadership.²⁹ Similarly, at the sub-national level, only 9.9 percent of 1019 candidates for Nigerian state houses were women, and only 4.7 percent (48 women) won their seats.

Within the Senate, no women have been elected into any of the key leadership positions, such as President or Deputy, Majority Leader or Deputy, Minority leader or Deputy, or the Chief Whip or Deputy. At present, 20 percent of cabinet ministries are headed by women—a far cry from the 35 percent quota contained in the 2006 gender policy.

WOMEN IN POLITICAL PARTIES

Socio- cultural, institutional, and individual barriers still come into play when it comes to women and their membership and participation in political parties. The general finding from this research is that while women participate in political activities, they do not officially register to become members of political parties. The level at which women register to join political parties is, however, unknown due to the absence of relevant party registration data for political parties that were included in this study.

Findings from this research showed that registering to be a member of a political party is a first step to growing as a politician; only very few women actually register to join political parties compared to men. Meeting times and venues are also factors that limit women's registration as voters and active participation in politics. While formal meetings are scheduled during working hours in most cases, less formal caucus meetings are less accessible to women in terms of the timing and the venue, further excluding women and it is during these informal meetings that key decisions are made.

“Most meetings are held at party offices where everybody has equal access to. If it is caucus meetings, you do that at a private location or a hotel at night because of security. My experience is that most of the women who are caucus members do not have husbands. And again, they are aged women. Thirdly, they have vast experience in politics and they are hand picked because they have a lot of contributions.” —Man politician

“Politics is practiced late at night. The meetings you see in the afternoon are not real meetings—they are general meetings. Officially, caucus meetings where decisions are being taken, you hardly find them accessible. Like the NWC meeting, you can't go there if you are not a member and sometimes they also meet at night.” —Woman politician

There was a marked difference in responses along gender lines, on the views of women in political parties. The majority of men felt that women and men have equal access and opportunity to take on leadership positions within political parties. However, the majority of the women believe men have more opportunities. The two largest political parties; All Progressive Congress (APC) and PDP, have women occupying the woman leader and deputy woman leader positions alone. The LP has women occupying four of the 19 NWC positions. The Social Democratic Party (SDP) and

²⁸ <https://www.ipu.org/parliament/ng>

²⁹ <https://carnegieendowment.org/2023/05/09/why-women-haven-t-been-successful-in-nigerian-elections-pub-89707>

Young Progressive Party (YPP) have four and seven women members, respectively, as part of the NWC.

“Political parties are apprehensive that having a woman at the helm of the political landscape might jeopardize their chances of winning elections. The environment is perceived as unsafe for women, and troublemakers take advantage of this vulnerability, knowing that women are more likely to retreat in the face of disturbances.” —Woman politician

Political parties have made limited voluntary efforts to promote women’s participation and these initiatives have often been driven by party leaders who are committed to fostering inclusiveness. The success of these efforts remain debatable with more women saying that these efforts have had little to no impact on increasing the number of women candidates. For example, in 2019, the PDP took a significant step by increasing the number of ex-officials. Within each ward, a mandate was established that there should be a minimum of six women, similarly at the state and national levels, with a requirement of 13 women.

BARRIERS AND OPPORTUNITIES TO WPPL

SOCIO-CULTURAL FACTORS

Socio-cultural factors embody assumptions about appropriate norms and practices, shaping social expectations as well as personal attitudes and behaviors. In the case of WPPL, these factors reinforce an association between political power and men and masculinity, making it difficult for women to be seen and accepted as legitimate political actors. Concerningly, Nigeria ranks 139 out of 156 countries on the World Economic Forum's Gender Gap Index.³⁰

Patriarchal norms strictly structure gender roles.

“Although advocacy efforts have aimed to increase women's participation in politics, challenges remain. One of the primary contributing factors, in my view, is the enduring influence of patriarchal norms. This societal mindset tends to prioritize men and often disregards the potential of women in political leadership.” — Electoral official

One of the main socio-cultural barriers for women's political participation in Nigeria is its patriarchal culture that undermines and restricts women's ability to meaningfully and equally participate in political life. Gender stereotypes built on patriarchal beliefs place women at a disadvantage, ascribing specific attributes, characteristics, or roles to women, and limiting their success in the political space.³¹ Patriarchy compounds the challenges women leaders face, with some men feeling threatened by their authority and exploiting the patriarchal system to demoralize them, creating a hostile environment where women leaders must navigate not only gender-based biases but also resistance restricting from deeply deep-rooted societal norms. Nigerian women are disadvantaged both in private and public life – from marriage status to property ownership and inheritance rights.³² This translates into limited economic and political agency.

Cultural attitudes toward gender equality in Nigeria are complex and varied. Because of restrictive gender roles, women's lives are mostly limited to domestic and caregiving work. These domestic duties are likely more restrictive on women who are poorer, have attained lower levels of education, or are in more rural areas compared with women from urban areas or of higher socio-economic status. This stereotype not only discourages women from pursuing political careers but also makes it difficult for them to gain the necessary experience and support.

‘I was the returning officer for my party, and we made sure that this woman fails and she failed. Some of the factors we used is she is a housewife; no responsible housewife should involve in politics.’ —Man politician

Conservative religious and cultural interpretations hinder women's participation.

Additionally, religious beliefs play an important role in shaping attitudes toward gender equality. Nigeria is a religiously diverse country with a substantial Christian and Muslim population, and both faiths play a pivotal role in shaping societal norms and values. As noted in the background

³⁰ The World Bank. “The Global Gender Gap Report - 2021.” https://tcdata360.worldbank.org/indicators/af52ebe9?country=NGA&indicator=27962&viz=line_chart&years=2006,2021

³¹ Eguavon, A. A. (2018). Patriarchy and the state of Women participation in Governance in Edo State of Nigeria. Archives of Business Research – Vol.6, No.1

³² Taiwo Ajala (2016). Social Construction of Gender Roles and Women's Poverty in African Societies: the Case of the Nigerian Woman. *International Journal of Gender and Women's Studies*, Vol. 4, No. 2, pp. 1-10

section, the majority religions in Nigeria, wields a great deal of influence over socio-cultural norms, and the way these teachings are interpreted in Nigeria emphasizes the importance of men leadership and discourages women from pursuing certain roles or careers.³³ Furthermore, Nigeria has severe restrictions on sexual and reproductive rights, in part due to religion's influence on the country, demonstrating how influential religious institutions are not only on the socio-cultural norms but also on the legal and institutional framework. The religious and cultural stigmas also put defenders of these rights at elevated risk of violence.

Cultural practices such as giving young girls out in early marriage, female genital mutilation, and degrading treatment of widows directly obstructs women's engagement in governance.³⁴ Extremist groups such as Boko Haram manipulate religious practices to further restrict women's access to public and political life. For example, the practice of "Purdah" in some parts of Northern Nigeria, results in women and girls being segregated from their families and communities with access only to their spouses. Mandatory covering of women in public places, and other gender-based discrimination, contribute to an environment where women's individual and collective agency is severely hampered.³⁵ Additionally, customary laws dictate that women cannot inherit land or landed property from their fathers or husbands, further reinforcing their subordinate status in relation to men and limiting their access to financial resources.

"When you talk to the religious leaders, they will tell you it is a misconception but when they go back, they still practice the same thing because they don't give women leadership even in the church and when you go to the mosque it is the same thing. I think they don't really support it like that. If they do, it will start from them." —Man politician

"You are talking about the African society whereby women are only to be seen and not to be heard and this is part and parcel of culture all over and by so a lot of grounds are being established based on culture and other values deny women the opportunity to play in their in politics." —Traditional leader

"Looking at the history of leadership in Nigeria, it is known that men are the leaders while women are meant to stay at home. What affects women participation is the culture, the religion and the political atmosphere. If this must change, we must deal with the culture, then the religion and then facing the political atmosphere." —Man politician

Candidacy registration tied to spousal electoral district.

These barriers dictate that women can contest elections only in the electoral constituency where their spouse is registered, rather than their places of birth. Upon marriage to someone from another locality or state, women face losing their eligibility to run for political positions in their hometowns or state of origin. Even within their marital communities, women can face discrimination, as they may not be considered full-fledged community members when seeking political office. This practice hinders women's access to political leadership roles, perpetuates

³³ Akindele, Iyiola Tomilayo. "The Role of Gender and Religion on Women Participation in Decision Making Process in Nigeria." September, 2020.

³⁴ Mohammed, Oluwaseyi & Dahunsi, Olukayode. (2022). Socioeconomic Constraints Women Face in Nigeria: An Analysis from NOI Polls-Women's Opinion Survey. ([PDF](#)) [Socioeconomic Constraints Women Face in Nigeria: An Analysis from NOI Polls-Women's Opinion Survey \(researchgate.net\)](#)

³⁵ Adamu R., (2023). Women Participation in Nigerian Politics: Challenges, and Prospects to Nigerian Democracy. International Journal for Humanity Studies (IJHS) Vol 6. (2):301-314

gender inequality, and restricts their representation in Nigerian politics, reinforcing a pattern of male dominance in the political sphere

“I’m married now and have been with my husband for almost 6 years and I’m known in my local government of birth, but because I’m married to someone outside my LGA, I cannot contest for any political position at my place of birth.” Even in the places of marriage, women face discrimination as they are not regarded as community members when they intend to contest elections in the communities they have married into.” —Woman politician

Access to public and political spaces vary by region.

Due to socio-cultural barriers, such as restrictions on women’s movement and socializing, particularly in Northern Nigeria, it took a while before women started coming out to vote, more men actively participate in voting. During this period where women were excluded, the men built allies, learned the roles, and mastered the game. Few southern women are active but still the men started engaging in politics long before the women.

“To men it is not the people that repress women’s political participation but the prevailing culture and the political set up. Because in some cultures women are not even allowed to go out. They are strictly in their homes as housewives and mothers. For her to even come out to vote, is a problem. We have not reached that level that women will walk side by side with the men.” —Woman CSO member

Respondents mentioned that in the North, religion and culture supposedly forbid women to be leaders but they can be representatives. For example, a woman cannot be president, governor, or Local Government Chairman but can be a member of the House of Representatives. When men politicians or political parties need women to work for them, they are coerced and appreciated but when women want to be recognised as having the capability to be a part of the leadership structure or run for office, they are negatively labeled. For example, the New Nigeria People’s Party (NNPP) in Kano State is not so supportive of women running for office, supposedly for religious and cultural reasons.

“I moved from APC to PDP because APC wouldn’t give me a ticket, I contested for primaries in PDP and won after which I became the target of some party members who wanted to sell my certificate to a man and. I decided to go to PDP because even though NNPP is strong in Kano, the party does not recognize women to be in politics.” —Woman politician

Culturally, some communities in Nigeria practice male preference which disadvantages women from birth. We see that come to bear when some families had to make a choice of which of the children to send to school and also who gets trained to take over the family business. All of these contribute in making the man more prepared than the woman to take on leadership roles and being financially viable.

INSTITUTIONAL FACTORS

Institutional factors structure the political environment in Nigeria, establishing the rules and systems in which political actors operate and the formal and informal dynamics of political life. These factors interact with socio-cultural norms and individual-level characteristics, and decisions to shape opportunities for women and men to become politically engaged and exercise political influence. Institutional factors shaping WPPL include features of the electoral system, the political

party system, and the broader political and legal context. Elite behaviors in the face of these opportunities and constraints can also be considered institutional factors, with elites serving as gatekeepers to women's entry to, and exclusion from, political institutions and, in turn, political voice.

LEGAL FRAMEWORK

Despite the existence of legal foundations promoting gender equality, implementation remains elusive. The Nigerian Constitution, National Gender Policy, and other treaties provide a framework for women's inclusion in politics, but the absence of enforceable legislation hampers their effectiveness.

The constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria,³⁶ provides the framework that guarantees women's rights to political participation in governance and leadership. These are the sections of the constitution that support women's right to participate in politics and public life:

- Chapter II - Section 14 (1) (Fundamental objectives and directive principles of State Policy); the constitution states that 'The Federal Republic of Nigeria shall be a State based on the principles of democracy and social justice'
- Section 15 (2) talks about national integration being encouraged whilst discrimination on the grounds of origin, sex, religion, status, ethnic or linguistic association or ties being prohibited.
- Section 15 (3) (c) states that for the purpose of promoting national integration, the State shall encourage intermarriage among persons from different places of origin, religion, or ethnicity.
- Section 17 (1) and (2a) stress that the State social order is founded on ideals of freedom, equality, and justice and that every citizen shall have equality of rights, obligations, and opportunities before the Law.
- Section 40 provides for every Nigerian, the freedom to belong to a political party.

In 2006, the National Gender Policy (NGP) was developed by the Ministry of Women's Affairs and Social Development to contribute to building, 'a just society devoid of discrimination, harness the full potentials of all social groups regardless of sex or circumstance, promote the enjoyment of fundamental human rights and protect the health, social, economic and political well being of all citizens in order to achieve equitable rapid economic growth.'³⁷ The NGP outlines the government's commitment to promoting gender equality and women's empowerment in various aspects of society, including politics, education, employment, and health. It serves as a guiding document, providing a roadmap for policies and programs aimed at advancing gender equity in Nigeria. Some of the limitations of the policy include lack of legal binding, limited accountability, inconsistent implementation across different government agencies, vulnerability to changes in government, and inadequate penalties for violations. The recommendation for 35 percent women representation in elected and appointed positions, therefore, has been largely symbolic and not met consistently by any political institution in Nigeria.

³⁶ <https://nicn.gov.ng/publication/gazette.pdf>

³⁷ <https://csj-ng.org/wp-content/uploads/2020/11/National-Gender-Policy.pdf>

In 2022, a Federal High Court³⁸ ordered the Nigerian Government to implement the 35 percent Affirmative Action prescribed in the NGP for public sector appointments. The court case, brought by women CSOs, was progress in itself, it also prompted a revision of the NGP to set a new target of 50:50 gender parity in elected and appointed positions later that year. Women's rights groups then worked alongside MPs to propose five draft pieces of legislation to bolster women's equal rights and promote their participation and representation in politics:

1. *Citizenship bill* to provide citizenship for foreign spouses of Nigerian women,
2. *Affirmative action bill* requiring at least 35 percent of political party administration and appointed positions are women,
3. *Indigenship bill* allowing women to become official residents the state of her spouse, and run for public office after five years of residency,
4. *Quota bill* requiring at least 35 percent of federal and state executive councils or ministerial and commissioner positions be held by women,
5. *Reserved seat bill* creating 111 additional reserved seats for women in the NASS.

The NASS originally rejected all five bills, but agreed to reconsider the first three following protests by women groups.³⁹ No progress has been made to date. Legislators have consistently resisted implementing gender equality measures such as binding quotas. Several bills have been rejected on the grounds that they compromise traditional Christian or Islamic beliefs.⁴⁰

“To our greatest surprise, the night before the day they will pass those bills, a section of the national assembly, predominantly northern senators, held a meeting in the dead of the night and said they will call their friends and tell them not to allow the bills to be passed. They didn’t even look at the bills, they came and threw the five bills out. The Deputy Senate President was the one who co-sponsored those bills, the Speaker had his signature on those bills, the Deputy Speaker was involved and even those who were part of those bills voted against them.” — Women CSOs

The lack of a legal framework, with clear enforcement mechanisms, for gender equality impedes efforts to address historical disparities and systemic biases. Moreover, the absence of legislation creates legal barriers to women's electoral candidacies, with requirements like nomination fees or educational qualifications disproportionately affecting women aspirants. It also fails to provide adequate protection against gender-based discrimination, harassment, and violence, leaving women politicians without sufficient legal recourse.

FEDERAL INSTITUTIONS

At the federal level, there are two institutions with broad remit to impact women's political participation in Nigeria: the Federal Ministry of Women Affairs and Social Development (FMWASD), and the Independent National Election Commission (INEC).

The Ministry is responsible for the development and implementation of policies and programs that address gender-related issues, including women's political participation. The Ministry was the

³⁸ <https://www.premiumtimesng.com/news/headlines/522195-affirmative-action-court-orders-nigerian-govt-to-reserve-35-of-public-offices-for-women.html?tztc=1>

³⁹ <https://www.iri.org/news/wdn-bolsters-nigerian-womens-political-leadership-in-the-wake-of-legislative-disappointment/>

⁴⁰ [Towards overcoming gender challenges in community participation — Appointments — The Guardian Nigeria News – Nigeria and World News](#)

lead author of the 2006 NGP and oversaw revisions in 2022. The ministry collaborates with National Agency for the Prevention of Trafficking in Persons (NAPTIP) and CSOs in tackling issues of violence against women. While the Ministry plays a coordination role, it has no enforcement mandate and to date, has not taken a firm stance on implementation of the NGP or other recommendations for gender equality in the political space. There are mixed views on the value and authority of the Ministry. Several men politician respondents suggested that the FMWASD be scrapped altogether, while civil society and women politicians believed it should be resourced to better provide protection services to women and enforce punishments on political parties for non-compliance with NGP.

While independent from the state, legislation overseeing the INEC's work, along with its operating protocols to regulate the electoral process, give the institution unique agency over women's participation in politics. The Electoral Act is largely gender blind, with only reference to women regarding creating separate queues during voting (Section 49), leaving many opportunities for reform.⁴¹

INEC's inconsistent management has adverse consequences for women in politics, amplifying the barriers they encounter. Women politicians and CSO representatives expressed their displeasure with INEC's inability or unwillingness to regulate the excesses of election funding and spending by candidates and political parties as well as the high cost of nomination and other fees imposed by parties. For example, Section 87 of the Electoral Act grants INEC the power to place limitations on amounts to be contributed or spent on candidate campaigns. In practice, the Commission is not to be exercising its powers of sanctioning any party or individuals that contravene the law, allowing money to flow virtually unchecked. This has a chilling effect on women's interest and ability to mount compelling campaigns against their male counterparts.

Following passage of the NGP, the INEC adopted its own Gender Policy (IGP),⁴² seeking to mainstream gender considerations in all areas of its activities. The policy also opens the door for the INEC to advocate with political parties to have gender considerations on party rules and regulations, including the candidate nomination process, which the INEC is meant to oversee. However, again, the INEC has not taken clear actions to mount pressure on political parties to adopt voluntary measures to enfranchise women as candidates or within party structures. Furthermore, INEC's role in monitoring media coverage during campaigns is vital, but it does little to rectify the prevalent bias against women candidates in media reporting, which significantly obstructs their campaign efforts and aspirations for political leadership.

POLITICAL PARTIES

"This is the worst election in the history of Nigeria since 1999. The past four years, we intensified advocacy more than ever before. We worked with the civil societies aggressively, only for the political parties to turn against us. Power has been given so much to the governors because they are the ones that fund the political parties in the state." —Woman politician

A primary institutional factor contributing to this gender gap is the inherent patriarchal structure of Nigerian political parties. These parties often exhibit deeply entrenched male-dominated leadership hierarchies. Consequently, women face considerable hurdles when trying to secure candidacies and positions of influence. Their access to critical decision-making roles within

⁴¹ The Federal Government Printer. (2022). <https://placng.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/02/Electoral-Act-2022.pdf>

⁴² <https://inecnigeria.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/10/INEC-GENDER-POLICY-2021-2025.pdf>

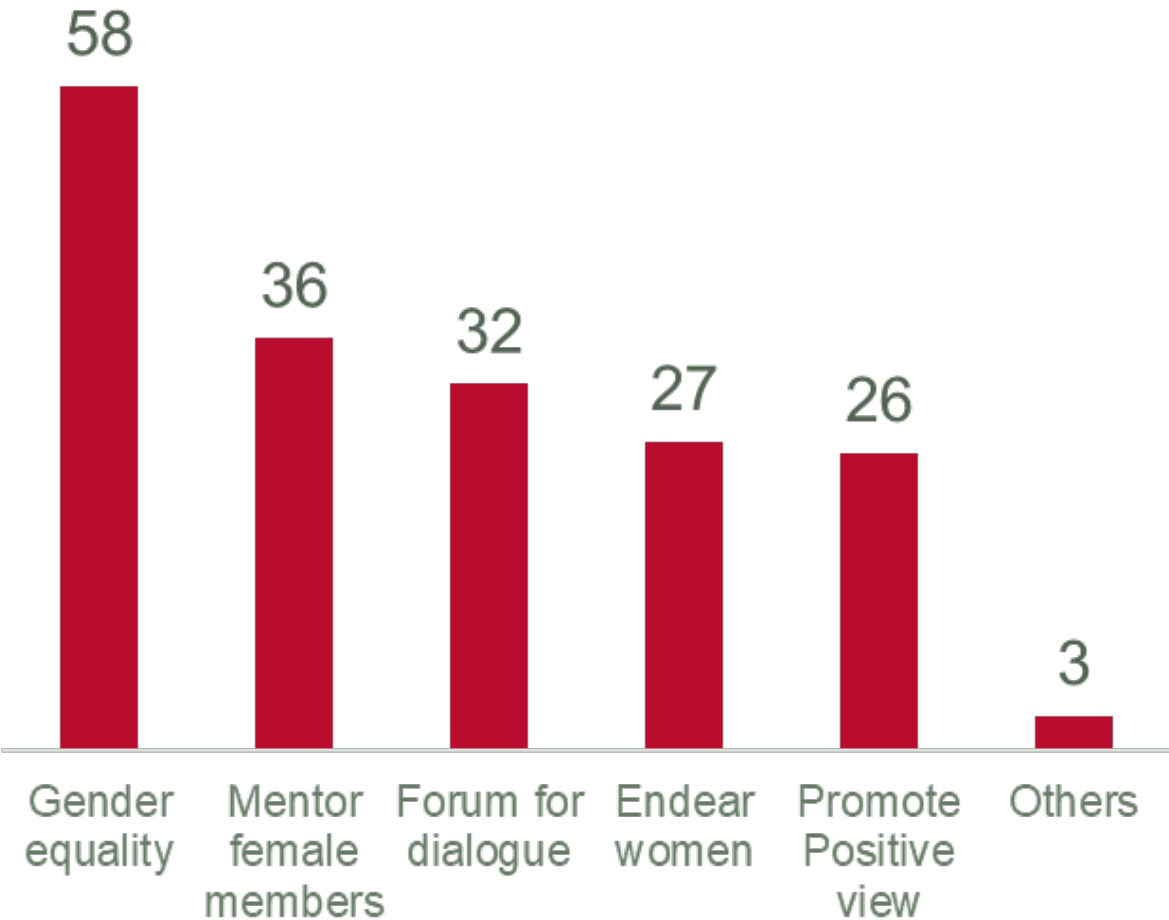
political parties is hampered by these deeply ingrained gender biases. The positions readily available for women in those parties are women leaders, mobilization officers, and in a limited number of cases, as members of the NWC.

While all political parties proclaim to pursue gender equality within their constitutions and manifestos, practice is starkly different from these stated aspirations. While some parties have established quotas for women's inclusion, the implementation of these quotas remains inconsistent. For example, All Progressive Grand Alliance (APGA)⁴³ commits to taking several measures to achieve gender parity including awareness programs to fight inequality, promotion of the 35 percent NGP quota, promoting capacity building of women party members, encouraging women to seek elective offices, and appointing women in key positions. Where other parties provide for only one woman to be included in some of the committees, the LP provides for two women. The LP also provides for two out of the required four National Deputy Chairman to be women and the composition of their NWC provides for at least one out of the three Deputy National Chairman to be a woman. The LP constitution also presents an opportunity for the mentorship of women as it shows the powers and functions of the State Executive Council to implement the educational programs of the party as well as propagate the party ideologies, program, and manifesto.

The assessment respondents did not provide a consistent response regarding the existence of women's wings within political parties. While some male respondents indicated the absence of women's wings, women respondents asserted the presence of such wings within the same parties. Notably, some male politicians expressed the view that women's wings should be abolished to enable the mainstreaming of women across the party leadership structure, rather than confining them to a specific position. However, as indicated in the chart below, there were respondents who believed that women's wings were valuable and could serve as platforms for mentoring women within the parties.

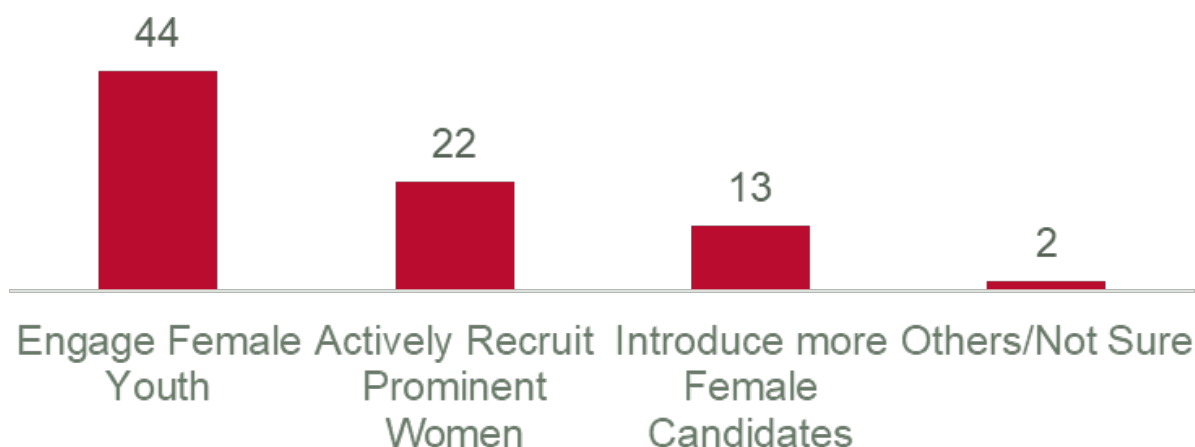
⁴³ <https://www.inecnigeria.org/wp-content/uploads/2019/02/APGA-Constitution.pdf>

Figure 4. Perceived roles of the women wing of political parties



Women's roles within political parties are often confined to Women Wings, primarily tasked with mobilizing women votes for the parties. Furthermore, some political parties view nominating women candidates as a vulnerability, raising questions about the absence of eligible male candidates within the community. Paradoxically, it appears that a specific subset of women benefit from the system, primarily those perceived to have politically influential husbands, fathers, or family connections. Women interviewees and focus group participants representing parties, civil society, and media all expressed their concern that women candidates do not receive financial support from their political parties during campaign periods. According to women politicians, instead of extending financial assistance to women candidates, these political parties engage in what can be described as extortion, compelling candidates to finance the campaigns of party officials and other party-related activities.

Figure 5. Strategies to include females in political parties



While some political parties offer women aspirants free nomination forms, they often still have to cover expenses related to Expression of Interest forms and other party-mandated dues, such as contributions for administrative costs during elections. For instance, both the APC and the African Democratic Congress (ADC) provide free nomination forms to women aspirants, as well as to People with Disabilities. However, under the APC, youth aspirants are required to pay 50 percent of the form's cost. APC's policy regarding whether a women youth candidate would be exempt from this 50 percent fee remains unclear. This practice of providing free forms is often perceived as a mere token gesture, leaving women candidates to contend with significant financial challenges in their pursuit of political office.

The established political elite, firmly entrenched, exhibit a reluctance to embrace fresh entrants. This is evident in the persistent recycling of the same individuals, with many holding their positions for over two decades. Respondents emphasize that this issue is not exclusive to women; even young male politicians face similar hurdles. For instance, in a senatorial district, a woman aspiring to take on a prominent role typically requires the support and backing of a male figure to gain traction within the political arena.

"If you do not have a godfather, just forget it in politics. I am not saying you shouldn't participate, you should and if you are lucky, good and fine. Otherwise, it is still those godfathers who control things." —Woman politician

ELECTED WOMEN LEADERS

Elected women leaders in Nigerian political parties confront numerous challenges, which are exacerbated by the limited presence of women in leadership roles within the party's hierarchy, resulting in diminished influence in party decisions and activities. Women politicians shared several personal examples of being sidelined during the deliberation of significant party matters. Additionally, some women in leadership positions are perceived to prioritize their self-preservation over the broader interests of other women party members.

Furthermore, a distinct barrier faced by women in leadership roles, whether within political parties or in appointed positions, is the imposition of higher standards and expectations compared to their male counterparts. They are subjected to a heightened level of scrutiny and performance expectations. Actions or practices that may go unchallenged when initiated by men are magnified

and criticized when women are involved. Isolated incidents involving individual women can be unfairly generalized as representative of all women, whereas this is not typically the case for men, who are more readily excused from such generalizations.

Women elected leaders can take advantage of opportunities to contribute to the advancement of gender equality. In the description of the role of Women Leader within the party constitutions, the Women Leader is expected to develop strategies which would endear women to the party. As such, they can advocate for policies and practices that promote gender equality within their parties and champion initiatives aimed at increasing women's participation and representation in politics. As there is a big mentorship gap for women.

MEDIA

Women candidates encounter significant challenges when seeking media support during election campaigns. Most of these candidates face financial constraints, making it difficult to finance extensive media coverage. Moreover, the media landscape favors coverage of larger political parties. Access to the media is technically available to all, but it comes at a cost that many women candidates simply cannot afford. Beyond just the expense of securing media time, candidates are often required to pay for the appearance of party leaders who speak in support of the candidate. Media outlets operate as commercial entities driven by profit motives, which means that those who can afford media coverage are the ones who receive it. Consequently, while the media is expected to provide equal opportunities for coverage to all candidates, the reality often deviates from this ideal as financial capacity often dictates the level of attention a candidate receives.

Many of these media outlets are owned by men who may extend free airtime to their male political associates, further exacerbating the disparities in media access. Women respondents have also indicated that there is a dearth of success stories published about women leaders, failing to adequately showcase their accomplishments and contributions. Conversely, in discussions with women in the media, it was revealed that women candidates often require encouragement before they are willing to engage with the media and are typically more inclined to discuss issues related to women or family rather than a broader range of national topics.

INDIVIDUAL FACTORS

The third component of the political ecosystem focuses on decisions made at the individual level by women, which block or support women's access and voice as a group in political spaces. Informed by socio-cultural norms and political institutions, these individual decisions fundamentally shape who participates and has a voice in politics, and thus dictate the overall levels of WPPL. Participating in politics is a time-intensive endeavor, so women's participation in politics often depends on how much time they have available to dedicate to their participation. Because socio-cultural norms dictate that women be responsible for the home, women who also work outside the household have a double working day and even less time to participate in politics. For example, women may not have the time or resources to dedicate to needed training to prepare themselves to run for office, which then deters them from running at all.

ACCESS TO FUNDING

Results obtained from the research shows that limited access to funding to run campaigns and for other political activities is the most significant barrier that women aspirants face. Compared to men, women are rarely in charge of household income, generally have lower earning capacity

and are less likely to inherit or own landed properties, putting them at an economic disadvantage. This economic disempowerment therefore is a significant barrier to women participating in politics as voters.

“So, the most important basic significant barrier we must not forget is economic power. It is the reason why women stay in abusive relationships, it is the reason women do not have a voice, it is the reason women do not have agency because even though they have their preferred candidates, they have to oblige their husbands because they rely on them for their livelihood and sustenance.” — Woman politician

Limited access to party funding is also a significant barrier to women aspiring for and winning political seats in Nigeria where money plays a determinant role in politics.

“I know the level of acceptance I had within my constituency as the only female candidate that actively ran for that seat. The reason why I didn’t win my election was because I didn’t have money. There is this fact that we must realize, politics is a difficult space to be in.” —Woman politician

There are formal and informal channels where politicians incur expenditure in Nigerian politics. Formal channels include paying for party membership registration and dues which are imposed on all members of political parties. These are generally affordable to women members. Other formal costs incurred include purchase of party nomination and expression of interest forms. The cost of these forms is dependent on the post being contested for and on the political party. Most women face barriers at this level due to the exorbitant cost of forms; for example, the APC presidential nomination form in the 2023 elections cost about N100,000,000. While some political parties have waived the cost of nomination forms to encourage women candidates, women still have to pay for expression of interest and other party-imposed costs.

“Money politics is one of the biggest hurdles women face. Political parties decide fees to be paid by those with intention to run for office and the price keeps getting higher every election cycle.” —Man politician

The purchase of nomination and expression of interest forms confers eligibility to contest in party primaries where the party flag bearer is determined. Most political parties adopt the indirect primaries or consensus approach and the implication of this is that women who have less access to finance and are economically disadvantaged are unable to afford the high amounts of money needed to bribe delegates or “settle” other contenders. This is exacerbated by the fact that political party delegates will generally follow the instructions of the godfathers that nominated them. In addition, other contenders might only consider dropping their interest if they can be paid off or promised appointive positions in the event that the consensus candidate wins the elections. In both scenarios, the informal rule is that the highest payer is most likely to be the party flagbearer and it's only in a few cases that women are the highest payer or get financial support from other actors that can fund their ambition.

Once a candidate scales the primaries stage, then campaigns for election commences. Here also, significant costs are incurred, including media coverage and publicity costs such as printing of posters and banners, airtime on TV and Radio, newspaper ads and articles, transportation for in-person campaigns, and advocacy visits. Incurring these costs is made worse by the fact that formal campaigns go on for an extended period of up to 180 days making it more difficult for the women to keep up.

“There is also the issue of finance, our electoral system is quite expensive. Women don’t have money to compete against their male counterparts.” —Electoral officer

Research findings also showed that it is generally more difficult for women to raise funding for campaigns. In terms of access to finance, most politicians use personal funds to run for elections except in cases where families and friends support the political ambition of women. Political parties do not fund campaigns and generally do not support candidates financially.

LACK OF CAPACITY AND CONFIDENCE

Low levels of confidence and capacity were also found to be a significant barrier to WPPL. Some respondents acknowledged that women’s understanding of politics and political issues, willingness to be involved in politics, capacity to engage the electorate, and confidence to be in the political space and subsequently win elections is lower than men. As a result, this serves as a barrier to their participation and leadership. Women’s low confidence also affects their performance in other aspects of the campaigns such as media engagement and publicity.

“The women feel like they are not up to task, they don’t want to bring themselves to the face of the people because of course criticism will be there. “People are going to pick on the little things they will not see in a man but when a woman comes up, they will do that.” —WPPL expert

“Because women have internalized forms of inequality, there is a high probability that even when she is in that space, she is not going to make decisions that will favor women and girls. She is going to bow down to the wishes of her male colleagues.” —WPPL expert

Some other respondents were of the opinion that women don’t necessarily have lower political capacity but that women are generally judged based on higher standards than men, made worse by negative media coverage.

FAMILY SUPPORT

Family history and connections also play a role in women’s ability to access political leadership, which is a major barrier for many aspiring women political leaders. According to several research respondents, family members usually do not want to support women politicians because they do not want their wives or mothers to be exposed to the rough and violent nature of politics.

“Men are no longer comfortable allowing them [women] to participate, having the fear of promiscuity. Men have that fear, their husbands have that fear. And they are bound to be called names.” —Man politician

VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN IN POLITICS

Political violence, as described throughout this report, acts as an additional barrier to women’s participation. Women experience political violence in different ways than men do and face different challenges when seeking justice or support as survivors due to ingrained beliefs about women’s and men’s role in society and persistent sexism that continues to dictate attitudes and behaviors in Nigeria. The general perception that the political environment is violent, especially towards women, acts as a deterrent for some women who want to run as candidates or participate in other ways. Interviewees and respondents in the focus group of women in politics reported verbal attacks, especially online. While the women interviewed did not indicate that they chose to

leave their political work due to this kind of violence, all the women politicians interviewed emphasized that it was necessary to have the character that allows them to persevere, because elected or appointed women are not able to assume their positions without fear or threats of violence.

This environment of violence against women who work on these issues likely deters other women from joining these organizations or supporting these causes. According to interviewees and focus group participants, the participation and leadership of women within a CSO depends on women's personal ability or will to endure the difficulties of being in such public-facing roles on topics that are deemed controversial by society.

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ACTION

WOMEN'S POLITICAL PARTICIPATION AND LEADERSHIP

SOCIO-CULTURAL FACTORS

Socio-cultural barriers to women's political participation and leadership are related to restrictive gender norms, where prevailing misogynistic attitudes and prejudices about women's role in society impede their ability to exercise their civil rights. Because of these cultural attitudes, it remains a challenge for women to be successful outside of the domestic sphere and become more active in the public space. At the root of the individual and institutional challenges are the cultural views and social norms prescribed by a patriarchal culture, informed by conservative religious interpretations. To address this culture, implementing programming that addresses gender equality more holistically will pay dividends in both improving women's empowerment generally while also changing harmful attitudes that impede women's political participation and leadership. In particular, targeting men in relevant institutions and who are family members of women active in politics (or who would like to be active) can help remove some of those socio-cultural barriers.

Support gender transformative education programs to change attitudes and behaviors.

Donors, the government, and local stakeholders should develop culturally informed educational materials on civic education and WPPL to be disseminated both within schools and more broadly. These programs should involve young girls in leadership and begin to build their capacity and confidence. This will also help young children develop appreciation for women's leadership from a young age and help challenge gender stereotypes.

Shift harmful cultural views and behavior by engaging men, gatekeepers, and allies. Men who serve as gatekeepers in political parties, the INEC, and other public institutions should be educated on the pernicious effects of harmful gender stereotypes and the specific harms of patriarchal culture on men and women, giving them the tools to advocate for and promote women's political participation. Most WPPL programs, including those focused on the prevention of VAWP, are exclusively designed for women participants. Since men are the main perpetrators of VAWP, and most people elected and leading political parties are men, it is critical to involve them in efforts to decrease opposition or indifference to women's issues and WPPL. When engaging male allies, it is critical to demonstrate that women's rights and feminist values are not imported, but rather are part of the culture of the country. One way to demonstrate this is to work with men in Nigeria who have more progressive values as lead trainers or speakers when working with the gatekeepers of these institutions. It is also helpful to pair work with men with training with women leaders of the same institution; for example, working with women in the political parties to build skills (and in turn, break down individual barriers women face) could be coupled with programs with their men counterparts to break down socio-cultural and institutional barriers for women, garnering a more holistic approach. Another important facet of this work is identifying male allies in government and civil society and equipping them to increase their involvement and visibility in the promotion of WPPL. Networking this group of allies would support solidarity and confidence amongst the group to take responsibility for modeling the promotion of gender equality in political participation, including voting and standing for office.

Support advocacy to traditional leaders and institutions to support women candidature and leadership as a means of improving social outcomes. Advocacy should be conducted by men from similar socio, political, and cultural contexts with clear examples of how this has worked

in their climes. For example, since Northern Nigeria is predominantly Muslim, messages on promotion of WPPL should come from men from other West or North African countries where the population is predominantly Muslim. An alternative to this would be to generate evidence that locations with similar contexts as Northern Nigeria have indeed improved WPPL. This recommendation is mostly relevant to the north where religious and traditional influence wields strong and where women are less empowered politically.

Support WPPL public information campaigns, rooted in cultural values, that name and take on patriarchal behavior. The INEC and CSOs should collaboratively develop and deploy public awareness campaigns—related to and beyond voter education—which target women’s barriers to voting discovered as part of this analysis. Donors and implementing partners should design and implement long-term behavioral change communication campaigns targeted at members of the electorate on the ills of gender norms and stereotypes, harmful traditional practices, and harms of women’s exclusion in politics. Previous interventions on this have tended to be short term in nature. Engaging traditional leaders as spokespersons for these campaigns would also help tie messages of cultural heritage to changes in attitudes and behavior.

Training for diverse groups of media workers (regional/national, print, television, digital) to cover WPPL, VAWP, and GBV. Training content, delivered to men and women in the sector, would include the influence editorial and journalist staff have in conveying and transforming social norms; guidance to identify normalized behaviors and expressions that are discriminatory or violent; preventing and addressing gendered disinformation through their platforms; and preventing violence against women media workers.

INSTITUTIONAL FACTORS

While current laws guarantee women’s participation in political life, legislation to protect and enfranchise women throughout political institutions are lacking. Rather than providing pathways to participation, leaders of institutions, who are often men, consolidate power and do not provide opportunities for women’s political participation and leadership. It is essential that institutions such as political parties, the House of Representatives, and the INEC address existing barriers to women’s equal and meaningful political participation and leadership. The following discussion addresses these barriers.

Regroup and reignite advocacy efforts for passage of gender bills. Donors and implementing partners in partnership with CSOs, WPPL experts, and other advocates of WPPL should conduct an in-depth analysis of what did not work well and what factors led to the rejection of the five gender bills. This learning should inform a joint strategy that could be used to reintroduce these bills while taking into considerations existing strengths and opportunities that could lead to the success of these bills in the context of the newly elected NASS and other representatives. At the Federal level, CSOs in collaboration with other WPPL allies and women groups (i.e., Womanifesto, Women in Politics Forum (WIPF)) should work with the legislature to advocate for the implementation of the NGP affirmative action threshold. This should include both elected and appointed positions in government at the federal level.

Advocacy at the state level should be complementary and take into consideration state-specific context. For example, the South West region elected the highest number of Deputies, whereas there are more women legislators in the South East and South, with more women having near victories in North East governorship elections. These particular regional strengths should inform advocacy messages and approaches. Consideration should be given to working in the states where the highest number of women legislators won their seats in the last election, such as Kwara

and Akwalbom state. In addition, advocacy should be conducted on the need for more women involvement using those women as ambassadors in other regions.

INEC acts on existing authority, in partnership with CSOs, to advocate for gender equality in political parties. Since one of the most significant limiting factors to WPPL is the structure and operating system found in political parties, a key step towards reversing this negative trend includes instituting gender quotas in political parties. A two-pronged approach, whereby the INEC activates its existing Gender Policy and simultaneously organizes regular engagement with party leadership on the importance of adopting measures to meet the NGP thresholds including the gender quota for candidacy and positions within party leadership would be most successful. These consultations should also serve as an opportunity to reinforce the INEC's responsibility and intention to monitor candidate nomination and financing protocols in the future, incentivizing party leadership to review procedure well in advance of future elections. The INEC should work in close consultation and coordination with CSOs, who can advocate for a law that mandates political parties implement gender quotas in their leadership structures. Different leadership models can be explored including: having men and women party chairman or also vice chairman, 30 percent of the NWC and NEC to be women, revamped candidate nomination, and campaign financing procedures that are transparent, equitable, and applied. The INEC should also develop and publicize enforcement measures noting that failure to comply may result in fines, cancellation of candidate slates, and deregistration of the political party.

Media should build trust with, and promote women candidates. In addition to building the capacity of the media, the strained relationship between the media and women politicians who fear of being misinterpreted and placed in a position where they can be ridiculed should be addressed. Beyond conducting interviews, media houses should also consider conducting docuseries on the achievements of women politicians that highlight areas where they have made strides and the benefits of having women as leaders. Finally, understanding that media coverage involves money which women lack, donors and implementing partners should consider funding media interventions aimed at amplifying the successes of women politicians. While this may be more impactful at the federal level, this should be done at the state level where women politicians are more known and close to the electorate who are more likely to engage with released media content.

INDIVIDUAL FACTORS

Women in positions of political leadership or those attempting to enter politics are often deterred by difficulties balancing family and political life, a lack of relevant knowledge or skills, threats of violence, and a lack of familial support. These individual factors are often the simplest to address—through education and training programs—but any support to break down individual barriers must come with accompanying efforts to eliminate institutional and socio-cultural barriers as well to address the entire WPPL ecosystem.

There exists a cohort of young leaders across all sectors that key donors and implementing partners, including the USAID have engaged and built their leadership capacities. This cohort of leaders can be supported to advance their political leadership skills by designing and rolling out long term programmes that expose them to government and governance systems and processes for a sustained period of time. The potential of this approach is that these leaders are more gender conscious and more exposed to the need for equality, equity, and social inclusion. The assumption is that these leaders will go on to become mid-level politicians in the near future and be able to support WPPL.

Consistent and proactive capacity building of women party members. Previous training for women politicians have largely been organized close to elections and then significantly dwindle after each election cycle. International and Nigerian CSOs should develop ongoing training opportunities for women politicians, in partnership with political party leadership, to build sustainable pipelines for women's leadership. In addition to traditional training on election campaigning and women's mobilization, skill-building to better equip women for media engagement (both as spokespersons, and in terms of developing their own strategic communications plans), and knowledge of the legal framework surrounding political organizing and elections should be prioritized. Embedded in these topics should be coaching on developing a personal security plan—identifying threats including physical, psychological, financial, and digital—including plans and networks for support women can engage proactively.

Design and implement a mentorship program for women politicians. One key finding from this research was the apparent lack of mentorship opportunities for women politicians to learn the formal and informal rules needed to deepen participation and leadership in politics. Building on past programs funded by USAID, women leaders of political parties at the federal and state level can be engaged in peer mentoring. Multidimensional mentoring—across generations, parties, and sex—should be considered in a tailored, pairing process. Opportunities for one-on-one mentoring are likely most appropriate within the same political party. However, complementing these relationships with semi-regular gatherings to address consistent points in common could spawn additional learning and networking.

As a supplement to Nigerian peer networks and mentoring, structured engagement with politicians from similar socio-cultural contexts outside Nigeria should be explored. These transnational efforts should tap into regional and global networks of elected women leaders to build mentor cohorts of women and men hailing from context with similar religious, economic, and conflict dynamics found in Nigeria's Northern region.

Provide programs that support women's access to and control over financial resources. As noted above, political campaigns and elected positions often require significant resources. Providing programs that support women's economic empowerment can have crossover effects on promoting their political empowerment, both by providing them with the necessary confidence and skills and by helping them earn the resources they need to be competitive in politics. Programming could focus on livelihood maintenance while women participate in political campaigns. In addition, there are several media outlets that focus on making women candidates more visible such as the women radio and National Association of Women Journalists (NAWOJ). These organizations can be supported to ensure that women get the coverage they need without worrying about financial implications of the coverage. Capacity building on fundraising should also be considered.

ANNEX A: DATA COLLECTION SOURCES

DESK REVIEW

POLITICIAN SURVEY

Table 1: Politicians Surveyed

POLITICAL PARTY	GENDER		NO. OF SURVEYS
	MALE	FEMALE	
ADC	2	3	5
APC	31	18	49
APGA	0	0	0
LP	8	2	10
PDP	13	19	32
NNPP	9	4	13
SDP	2	2	4
YPP	1	2	3

KEY INFORMANT INTERVIEWS

Table 2: Key Informants Interviewed

STAKEHOLDER GROUP	GENDER	LOCATION	CHARACTERISTIC 2	NO. OF KIIS
Politician - Non Elected	F	Multiple Locations	Multidisciplinary	5
Politician - Elected	F	Abuja	Multidisciplinary	1
Politician - Non-Elected	M	Gombe	Multidisciplinary	1
Politician - Elected	M	Kaduna	Electoral Process	1
Electoral Officers	F	Abuja and Gombe	Gender Desk Officer	2
Electoral Officers	M	Uyo	Gender Desk Officer	1
Political Party Leaders	M	Abuja	Party Leaders, APC, SDP and 3 YPP	
Political Party Leaders	F	Abuja	National Treasurer, LP	1
WPPL Expert - CSO	F	Several Locations and Virtual	CSO Staff	4
WPPL Expert - CSO	M	Lagos and Abuja	CSO Staff	2
WPPL Expert - Academia	F	Kaduna	Professor	2
WPPL Expert - Media	F	Lagos	Journalist	1
WPPL Expert - Media	M	Abuja	Journalist	1
Donors and Implementing Partners	F	Abuja	Donor	1

STAKEHOLDER GROUP	GENDER	LOCATION	CHARACTERISTIC 2	NO. OF KIIS
USAID	F	Abuja	CSO	1
Traditional Leaders	M	Kaduna, Uyo and Gombe	Local leaders	3
Religious Leaders	M	Uyo	Religious leaders	1
TOTAL				31

FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSIONS

Table 3: Focus Group Discussions

NO.	GROUP DESCRIPTION	LOCATION	TOTAL PARTICIPANTS
1	Women in Politics	Abuja	6
2	Men in Politics	Abuja	5
3	Women in CSOs	Abuja	3
4	Men in CSOs	Abuja	6
5	Women in Media	Abuja	6
6	Women in Politics/Locally elected women	Akwalbom	6
7	Women in CSOs	Akwalbom	7
8	Men in Politics/Locally elected men	Akwalbom	8
9	Women in Politics/Locally Elected women	Gombe	7
10	Women in CSOs	Gombe	8
11	Men in Politics/Locally elected men	Gombe	9

ANNEX B. DATA COLLECTION INSTRUMENTS

FOCUS GROUP GUIDE: LOCALLY ELECTED MEN

CONSENT

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion. We work for The Cloudburst Group's Nigeria Assessment Team and we have been commissioned by the United States Agency for International Development (USAID) to conduct an assessment of women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria. USAID is a United States government agency that provides assistance to countries in the global south.

The focus group seeks to gather views on barriers and opportunities for women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria. Cloudburst is a non-political research organization. We do not represent the government or any political party.

The discussion should take approximately 60 minutes. Your participation does not involve any risks other than what you would encounter in daily life. Your participation is entirely voluntary, and you can choose not to answer a question or leave the discussion at any time without providing a reason.

In order to protect everyone's privacy, we will not include your name or any identifiable information in any of our reports. We also ask that anything we discuss during our group talk remains here with us.

We will be recording this session so we can write an accurate report of what was said. We ask that you do not mention your full name, your address, or your community's name, so your answers can remain confidential.

If you have any questions, you may ask them now or later, even after the discussion has started.

Do you agree to participate in this discussion today? Yes No

Do you agree to today's interview being recorded? Yes No

[Start recording if all participants agreed to recording]

INTRODUCTION

Before we start, we want to share some basic ground rules:

- You don't have to wait to be called on to talk—please jump in when you have something to say.
- Talk one at a time.
- Our goal is equal “airtime” so that everybody talks about the same amount.
- Say what you believe, even if it's not what everyone thinks. There are no wrong answers, just different opinions, and we want to hear them all.

****Administer the survey before the FGD starts**

FOCUS GROUP QUESTIONS

1. **In general, there are fewer women than men in elected political positions. In your view, what are the main reasons for this?**
2. **How active are women in local politics in Nigeria?**
3. **What support, if any, does your party give to women candidates?**
Do they encourage women to run for office?
Do they provide funding or training to women candidates?
Do parties tend to support certain types of women candidates over others?
4. **Based on what you have observed, are women taken seriously as local leaders?**
How do their experiences compare to those of men?
Are some types of women more likely than others to be taken seriously?
Do women have equal chances as men to be elected as head of the village or deputy of the local community?
5. **Do women in local politics face violence, intimidation, or harassment for their political work?**
If so, what do these attacks look like?
Who are the main perpetrators?
Do these attacks affect women's ability to participate in civil society?
Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?
6. **What policies or strategies do you think are needed to give women a greater voice in local politics—and politics more generally—in Nigeria?**
7. **What support do women need to be able to inform local government policy?**

FOCUS GROUP GUIDE: LOCALLY ELECTED WOMEN

CONSENT

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion. We work for The Cloudburst Group's Nigeria Assessment Team and we have been commissioned by the United States Agency for International Development (USAID) to conduct an assessment of women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria. USAID is a United States government agency that provides assistance to countries in the global south.

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- Say what you believe, even if it's not what everyone thinks. There are no wrong answers, just different opinions, and we want to hear them all.

****Administer the survey before the FGD starts**

FOCUS GROUP QUESTIONS

1. **How active are women in local politics in Nigeria?**

Why did you decide to run as a candidate in local elections?

Did anyone particularly encourage you to stand as a candidate?

Did anyone particularly discourage you from standing as a candidate?

How important is local politics as an entry point for women leaders, compared to men?

2. **What support, if any, does your party give to women candidates?**

Do they encourage women to run for office?

Do they provide funding or training to women candidates?

Do parties tend to support certain types of women candidates over others?

3. **Based on what you have observed, are women taken seriously as local leaders?**

How do their experiences compare to those of men?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be taken seriously?

Do women have equal chances as men to be elected as head of the village or deputy of the local kenesh?

4. **Do women in local politics face violence, intimidation, or harassment for their political work?**

If so, what do these attacks look like?

Who are the main perpetrators?

Do these attacks affect women's ability to participate in civil society?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?

5. **What policies or strategies do you think are needed to give women a greater voice in local politics—and politics more generally—in Nigeria?**

6. **What support do women need (training, skills, resources) to be able to inform local government policy?**

7. **Who are the Male allies on WPPL in your party?**

FOCUS GROUP GUIDE WOMEN IN CIVIL SOCIETY

INTRODUCTION

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion.

The focus group seeks to gather views on barriers and opportunities for women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria. The discussion should take approximately 60 minutes.

In order to protect everyone's privacy, we will not include your name or any identifiable information in any of our reports. We also ask that anything we discuss during our group talk remains here with us.

[If all participants all agreed to recording] We will be recording this session so we can write an accurate report of what was said.

Before we start, we want to share some basic ground rules:

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- Talk one at a time.
- Our goal is equal "airtime" – so that everybody talks about the same amount.
- Say what you believe, even if it's not what everyone thinks. There are no wrong answers, just different opinions, and we want to hear them all.

FOCUS GROUP QUESTIONS

Without sacrificing anonymity, let's go around the circle and briefly share the political roles we have played – for example, social movement activist, election candidate, party member, etc. Do not mention your specific organization or party names. This is just to get a sense of the perspectives in the room.

1. **How active are women in civil society in Nigeria?**

Do they mainly participate in women's organizations, or are women active in organizations and movements not specifically focused on gender issues?

Do women serve as leaders of any major civil society organizations?

How representative are civil society organizations of the diversity of women in the population? Where do women's groups tend to get their funding?

2. **Do women in Nigeria have the same opportunities as men to express their political opinions?**

Are there any actors that actively seek to repress women's civic and political rights? How effective are they in achieving these goals?

3. **Are there ways for women in civil society to influence government decision-making?**

Are there specific channels for communicating with and influencing government actors? Does the government listen to women's groups, or does it basically ignore them?

4. **Do women in civil society – including women human rights defenders – face violence, intimidation, or harassment for their political work?**
If so, what do these attacks look like? Who are the main perpetrators?
Do these attacks affect women's ability to participate in civil society? Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?
5. **What policies or strategies do you think are needed to give women a greater voice in civil society – and politics more generally – in Nigeria?**
6. **Do women in politics face violence, intimidation, or harassment for their political work?**
If so, what do these attacks look like? Who are the main perpetrators?
Do these attacks affect women's ability to participate in civil society? Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?
7. **Do women journalists face violence, intimidation, or harassment for their political reporting?**
If so, what do these attacks look like? Who are the main perpetrators?
Do these attacks affect women's ability to participate in civil society? Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?
8. **What policies or strategies do you think are needed to give women a greater voice in political journalism – and politics more generally – in Nigeria?**

FOCUS GROUP GUIDE MEN IN CIVIL SOCIETY

INTRODUCTION

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion.

The focus group seeks to gather views on barriers and opportunities for women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria. The discussion should take approximately 60 minutes.

In order to protect everyone's privacy, we will not include your name or any identifiable information in any of our reports. We also ask that anything we discuss during our group talk remains here with us.

[If all participants all agreed to recording] We will be recording this session so we can write an accurate report of what was said.

Before we start, we want to share some basic ground rules:

- You don't have to wait to be called on to talk, please jump in when you have something to say.
- Talk one at a time.
- Our goal is equal "airtime" – so that everybody talks about the same amount.
- Say what you believe, even if it's not what everyone thinks. There are no wrong answers, just different opinions, and we want to hear them all.

FOCUS GROUP QUESTIONS

Without sacrificing anonymity, let's go around the circle and briefly share the political roles we have played – for example, social movement activist, election candidate, party member, etc. Do not mention your specific organization or party names. This is just to get a sense of the perspectives in the room.

1. **How active are women compared to men in civil society in Nigeria?**

Do they mainly participate in women's organizations, or are women active in organizations and movements not specifically focused on gender issues?

Do women serve as leaders of any major civil society organizations?

How representative are civil society organizations of the diversity of women in the population? Where do civil society groups in Nigeria tend to get their funding?

2. **Do women in Nigeria have the same opportunities as men to express their political opinions?**

Are there any actors that actively seek to repress women's civic and political rights? How effective are they in achieving these goals?

3. **Based on what you have observed, are women taken seriously as political leaders?**

How do their experiences compare to those of men?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be taken seriously?

- 4. Do women in civil society – including women human rights defenders – face violence, intimidation, or harassment for their political work?**

If so, what do these attacks look like? Who are the main perpetrators?

Do these attacks affect women's ability to participate in civil society? Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?

- 5. What policies or strategies do you think are needed to give women a greater voice in civil society – and politics more generally – in Nigeria?**

FOCUS GROUP GUIDE WOMEN MEDIA WORKERS

INTRODUCTION

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion.

The focus group seeks to gather views on barriers and opportunities for women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria. The discussion should take approximately 60 minutes.

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- Say what you believe, even if it's not what everyone thinks. There are no wrong answers, just different opinions, and we want to hear them all.

FOCUS GROUP QUESTIONS

Without sacrificing anonymity, let's go around the circle and briefly share the political roles we have played – for example, social movement activist, election candidate, party member, etc. Do not mention your specific organization or party names. This is just to get a sense of the perspectives in the room.

1. What is the media environment like for women candidates and leaders?

Do women in politics receive the same level of media coverage as men in politics?

Are women politicians treated differently than men in terms of the substance of media coverage?

2. To what extent is there disinformation and/or hate speech against women in politics, either in the traditional media and on social media platforms?

If so, can you give some examples?

What is the impact of this hate speech and disinformation?

3. Based on what you have observed, are women taken seriously as political leaders?

How do their experiences compare to those of men?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be taken seriously?

4. Do women in politics face violence, intimidation, or harassment for their political work?

If so, what do these attacks look like? Who are the main perpetrators?

Do these attacks affect women's ability to participate in civil society? Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?

5. Do women journalists face violence, intimidation, or harassment for their political reporting?

If so, what do these attacks look like? Who are the main perpetrators?

Do these attacks affect women's ability to participate in civil society? Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?

6. What policies or strategies do you think are needed to give women a greater voice in political journalism – and politics more generally – in Nigeria?

FOCUS GROUP GUIDE: WOMEN IN POLITICAL PARTIES (NATIONAL)

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion. We work for The Cloudburst Group's Nigeria Assessment Team and we have been commissioned by the United States Agency for International Development (USAID) to conduct an assessment of women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria. USAID is a United States government agency that provides assistance to countries in the global south.

The focus group seeks to gather views on barriers and opportunities for women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria. Cloudburst is a non-political research organization. We do not represent the government or any political party.

The discussion should take approximately 60 minutes. Your participation does not involve any risks other than what you would encounter in daily life. Your participation is entirely voluntary, and you can choose not to answer a question or leave the discussion at any time without providing a reason.

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If you have any questions, you may ask them now or later, even after the discussion has started.

Do you agree to participate in this discussion today?	Yes	No
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Do you agree to today's discussion being recorded?	Yes	No
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[Start recording if all participants agreed to recording]

INTRODUCTION

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- Talk one at a time.
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- Say what you believe, even if it's not what everyone thinks. There are no wrong answers, just different opinions, and we want to hear them all.

FOCUS GROUP QUESTIONS

1. **How active are women in political parties in Nigeria?**
How important are the women's sections of political parties?
What is their primary purpose?
What type of support, if any, do they receive from the party?
Do the women's sections play any role in candidate selection?
Do the women's sections have any influence over the party platform?
2. **Are party meetings equally accessible to women and men?**
At what kinds of locations are party meetings held?
At what times of the day are party meetings usually scheduled?
Does the party offer childcare for members during its meetings?
3. **What support, if any, does your party give to women candidates?**
Do they encourage women to run for office?
Do they provide funding or training to women candidates?
Do they place women in electable districts or list positions?
4. **Do women in political parties face violence, intimidation, or harassment for their political work?**
If so, what do these attacks look like?
Who are the main perpetrators?
Do these attacks affect women's ability to participate in civil society?
Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?
5. **What is the purpose of the Women's MP Forum? Council? What does MP mean in our context?**
Is there a women MP forum/council?
What is the purpose of the women's MP forum/council?
How and why was it established?
What are the benefits of participation in the Forum? Council?
What are some of the major achievements of the Forum? Council?
What challenges has each body faced?
How were challenges addressed or overcome?

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. **What policies or strategies do you think are needed to give women a greater voice in political parties—and politics more generally—in Nigeria?**
2. **What support do women need (e.g., training, skills, resources) to be able to better inform local and national government policy?**

KEY INFORMANT INTERVIEW GUIDE: DONORS AND IMPLEMENTING PARTNERS

CONSENT

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is _____ [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague _____ [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion. We work for the Cloudburst Assessment Team and we have been commissioned by USAID to conduct an assessment of women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria.

The purpose of our discussion today is to hear about your experiences and views on barriers and opportunities for women in politics. The Cloudburst Group is a non-political research organization, and we are not related to the government or any political parties. We are completely neutral on all of the issues we'll be talking about; we're just here to learn about your experiences.

Our discussion should take approximately 60 minutes, but if your time is more limited, I can prioritize my questions [sample priority questions marked in bold]. Your participation does not involve any risks other than what you would encounter in daily life. Your participation is entirely voluntary and you can choose not to answer a question or leave the discussion at any time without providing a reason.

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[START THE RECORDING TO GET VERBAL CONSENT]

Do you agree to participate in this discussion today? Yes No

[IF THE RESPONDENTS SAY "YES," CONTINUE DISCUSSION]

BACKGROUND

1. **How is your organization involved in issues related to women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria?**
2. **What is your role within the organization?**

DONOR AND PARTNER ACTIVITIES

1. **What kinds of WPPL programming has your organization supported in Nigeria?**
Why did the organization choose these particular priority areas?

How effective was this programming in terms of its design and impact?

STAKEHOLDER ANALYSIS

1. **In Nigeria, who are the main actors, stakeholders, or institutions interested in advancing WPPL?**

What is your impression of this programming in terms of its design and impact?

What strategies do they favor for advancing WPPL?

Do they work together to advance WPPL?

If so, can you give some examples of joint activities?

2. **In Nigeria, who are the main actors, stakeholders, or institutions that oppose advancing WPPL?**

What strategies do they use to oppose advancing WPPL?

LESSONS LEARNED AND RECOMMENDATIONS

1. **Based on your experiences, what are the major barriers to advancing WPPL in Nigeria?**

Have donors/partners focused adequately on these barriers?

In your view, which interventions have been most effective?

In your view, which interventions have been least effective?

2. **Based on your experiences, what more could donors/partners do in this space?**

In your view, what are some promising opportunities for action?

3. **In general, what kinds of policies or strategies do you think are needed to advance women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria? These could include actions by the government, political parties, or civil society, for example.**

KEY INFORMANT INTERVIEW GUIDE: ELECTORAL OFFICIALS

CONSENT

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is _____ [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague _____ [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion. We work for the Cloudburst Assessment Team and we have been commissioned by USAID to conduct an assessment of women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria.

The purpose of our discussion today is to hear about your experiences and views on barriers and opportunities for women in politics. The Cloudburst Group is a non-political research organization, and we are not related to the government or any political parties. We are completely neutral on all of the issues we'll be talking about; we're just here to learn about your experiences.

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If you have any questions you may ask them now or later, even after the discussion has started.

[START THE RECORDING TO GET VERBAL CONSENT]

Do you agree to participate in this discussion today? Yes No

[IF THE RESPONDENTS SAY "YES," CONTINUE DISCUSSION]

BACKGROUND

1. **What is your role in the electoral process?**

BARRIERS AND OPPORTUNITIES: WOMEN VOTERS

1. **Do women register to vote at the same rates as men?**
If not, what are some of the reasons that women are less likely to register as voters?
2. **Do women turn out to vote at the same rates as men?**
If not, what are some of the reasons that women are less likely to turn out to vote?

3. **Are polling places equally accessible to women and men?**
Are polling places segregated by gender?
Are there measures in place to increase accessibility to women?
4. **Are women able to cast their votes in a free, secret, and secure manner?**
If not, what are some of the key challenges to women exercising their full right to vote?

BARRIERS AND OPPORTUNITIES: WOMEN CANDIDATES

1. **Many countries around the world have introduced gender quotas for candidates. What impact have quotas had on the number of women standing as candidates in Nigeria?**
Do political parties respect the quota requirements?
What does the electoral management body do, if anything, to ensure quota compliance?
Based on what you have observed, what kinds of women tend to benefit from quotas in Nigeria?
2. **Have quotas made a difference in terms of women's representation and political voice?**
3. **In general, there are fewer women than men in elected political positions. In your view, what are the main reasons for this?**
4. **How has the gender policy improved women's voters and leadership participation?**

VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN IN POLITICS

1. **Based on what you have observed, is it common for women voters to face violence, intimidation, or harassment on the campaign trail?**
If so, what do these attacks look like?
Who are the main perpetrators?
Do these attacks affect women's ability to be elected?
Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?
2. **Based on what you have observed, is it common for women candidates to face violence, intimidation, or harassment on the campaign trail?**
If so, what do these attacks look like?
Who are the main perpetrators?
Do these attacks affect women's ability to be elected?
Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?
3. **Based on what you have observed, is it common for women election workers to face violence, intimidation, or harassment?**
If so, what do these attacks look like?
Who are the main perpetrators?

Do these attacks affect women's ability to facilitate and/or observe the electoral process?

4. **Does the electoral management body monitor and/or respond to incidents of gender-based violence during elections?**

If so, what are the details of these interventions?

What is the impact, if any, of these interventions?

RECOMMENDATIONS

- I. **What kinds of policies or strategies do you think are needed to advance women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria? These could include actions by the government, political parties, the electoral management body, or civil society, for example.**

KEY INFORMANT INTERVIEW GUIDE: POLITICAL PARTY LEADERS

CONSENT

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is _____ [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague _____ [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion. We work for the Cloudburst Assessment Team and we have been commissioned by USAID to conduct an assessment of women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria.

The purpose of our discussion today is to hear about your experiences and views on barriers and opportunities for women in politics. The Cloudburst Group is a non-political research organization, and we are not related to the government or any political parties. We are completely neutral on all of the issues we'll be talking about; we're just here to learn about your experiences.

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[START THE RECORDING TO GET VERBAL CONSENT]

Do you agree to participate in this discussion today? Yes No

[IF THE RESPONDENTS SAY "YES," CONTINUE DISCUSSION]

****Administer the questionnaire before starting the KI**

BARRIERS AND OPPORTUNITIES: WOMEN PARTY MEMBERS

1. **In general, there are fewer women than men who join political parties. In your view, what are the main reasons for this?**
2. **Does your party have any special initiatives to attract women members?**
If so, do these differ in any way from efforts to attract male members?

3. **Are party meetings equally accessible to women and men?**
At what kinds of locations are party meetings held?
At what times of the day are party meetings usually scheduled?
Does the party offer childcare for members during its meetings?
4. **Is there a women's wing in your political party?**
If so, what is the main role of the women's wing?
Does the party provide any financial support or other resources to the women's wing?
Can the women's wing give input on the party platform?
Can the women's wing suggest political candidates?
5. **If not, have there ever been discussions in the party about a women's wing?**
6. **Do women have representation in the party's executive committee?**
If so, what kinds of positions do they hold?
Does the party have any policies to ensure women's participation in party leadership?

BARRIERS AND OPPORTUNITIES: WOMEN CANDIDATES

1. **Many countries around the world have introduced gender quotas for candidates. What impact have quotas had on the number of women standing as candidates in Nigeria?**
Do you support quotas as a measure to promote women in politics?
What kinds of women tend to benefit from quotas in Nigeria?
2. **Does your party provide any financial support to its candidates?**
If so, what is the nature of this support?
Is this support distributed evenly across candidates?
If not, what are the determinants of party support for particular candidates?
3. **Does your party help candidates with their campaigns in any other ways?**
If so, what does the party offer in the way of support?
Is this support distributed evenly across candidates?
If not, what are the determinants of party support for particular candidates?

BARRIERS AND OPPORTUNITIES: WOMEN LEADERS

1. **In general, there are fewer women than men in elected political positions. In your view, what are the main reasons for this?**
2. **After they are elected, do women have the same opportunities as men to take on positions of political leadership (e.g., as party leaders, parliamentary committee presidents, or cabinet ministers)?**
If not, what are the main reasons for this, in your view?

3. **When women are appointed to leadership positions, what types of issues are women given responsibility for?**
4. **Based on what you have observed, are women taken seriously as political leaders?**
How do their experiences compare to those of men?
Are some types of women more likely than others to be taken seriously?

VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN IN POLITICS

1. **Based on what you have observed, is it common for women candidates to face violence, intimidation, or harassment on the campaign trail?**
If so, what do these attacks look like?
Who are the main perpetrators?
Do these attacks affect women's ability to be elected?
Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?
2. **Based on what you have observed, is it common for women leaders to face violence, intimidation, or harassment for their political work?**
If so, what do these attacks look like?
Who are the main perpetrators?
Do these attacks affect women's ability to exercise their political functions?
Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. **What kinds of policies or strategies do you think are needed to advance women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria? These could include actions by the government, political parties, or civil society, for example.**

KEY INFORMANT INTERVIEW GUIDE: USAID STAFF

CONSENT

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is _____ [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague _____ [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion. We work for the Cloudburst Assessment Team and we have been commissioned by USAID to conduct an assessment of women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria.

The purpose of our discussion today is to hear about your experiences and views on barriers and opportunities for women in politics. The Cloudburst Group is a non-political research organization, and we are not related to the government or any political parties. We are completely neutral on all of the issues we'll be talking about; we're just here to learn about your experiences.

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[START THE RECORDING TO GET VERBAL CONSENT]

Do you agree to participate in this discussion today? Yes No

[IF THE RESPONDENTS SAY "YES," CONTINUE DISCUSSION]

BACKGROUND

1. **What is your role at USAID?**
2. **How long have you been working at USAID and elsewhere on issues related to WPPL?**

DONOR AND PARTNER ACTIVITIES

1. **What kinds of WPPL programming has USAID supported in Nigeria?**
Why did the organization choose these particular priority areas?
Can you provide some details on specific activities?
How effective was this programming in terms of its design and impact?

Does the Mission have any additional programming planned related to WPPL?

2. **Are there any activities by other donors or implementers that you think have been effective in advancing WPPL in Nigeria?**

If so, can you provide some details on these activities?

What was your impression of this programming in terms of its design and impact?

STAKEHOLDER ANALYSIS

1. **In Nigeria, who are the main actors, stakeholders, or institutions interested in advancing WPPL?**

What strategies do they favor for advancing WPPL?

Do they work together to advance WPPL?

If so, can you give some examples of joint activities?

2. **In Nigeria, who are the main actors, stakeholders, or institutions that oppose advancing WPPL?**

What strategies do they use to oppose advancing WPPL?

LESSONS LEARNED AND RECOMMENDATIONS

1. **Based on your experiences, what are the major barriers to advancing WPPL in Nigeria?**

Have donors/partners focused adequately on these barriers?

In your view, which interventions have been most effective?

In your view, which interventions have been least effective?

2. **Based on your experiences, what more could USAID do in this space?**

In your view, what are some promising opportunities for action?

Are there any partnerships that you think would be particularly fruitful?

3. **In general, what kinds of policies or strategies do you think are needed to advance women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria? These could include actions by the government, political parties, or civil society, for example.**

KEY INFORMANT INTERVIEW GUIDE: USAID STAFF

CONSENT

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is _____ [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague _____ [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion. We work for the Cloudburst Assessment Team and we have been commissioned by USAID to conduct an assessment of women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria.

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If so, can you provide some details on these activities?

What was your impression of this programming in terms of its design and impact?

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1. **In Nigeria, who are the main actors, stakeholders, or institutions interested in advancing WPPL?**

What strategies do they favor for advancing WPPL?

Do they work together to advance WPPL?

If so, can you give some examples of joint activities?

2. **In Nigeria, who are the main actors, stakeholders, or institutions that oppose advancing WPPL?**

What strategies do they use to oppose advancing WPPL?

LESSONS LEARNED AND RECOMMENDATIONS

1. **Based on your experiences, what are the major barriers to advancing WPPL in Nigeria?**

Have donors/partners focused adequately on these barriers?

In your view, which interventions have been most effective?

In your view, which interventions have been least effective?

2. **Based on your experiences, what more could USAID do in this space?**

In your view, what are some promising opportunities for action?

Are there any partnerships that you think would be particularly fruitful?

3. **In general, what kinds of policies or strategies do you think are needed to advance women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria? These could include actions by the government, political parties, or civil society, for example.**

KEY INFORMANT INTERVIEW GUIDE: MEN POLITICIANS

CONSENT

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is _____ [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague _____ [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion. We work for the Cloudburst Assessment Team and we have been commissioned by USAID to conduct an assessment of women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria.

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[START THE RECORDING TO GET VERBAL CONSENT]

Do you agree to participate in this discussion today? Yes No

[IF THE RESPONDENTS SAY "YES," CONTINUE DISCUSSION]

****Administer the questionnaire before starting the KII**

1. **Many countries around the world have introduced gender quotas for candidates. What impact have quotas had on the number of women standing as candidates in Nigeria?**

Do you support quotas as a measure to promote women in politics?

What kinds of women tend to benefit from quotas in Nigeria?

2. **How do candidates finance their campaigns in Nigeria?**

Does your party provide any funds to its candidates?

Is this support distributed evenly across candidates?

Do candidates have to raise their own funds for their campaigns?

Do you think, in general, it is more difficult for women than men to raise campaign funding?

3. What is the media environment like for women candidates?

Do women candidates receive the same level of media coverage as male candidates?

Are women candidates treated differently than men in terms of the substance of media coverage?

BARRIERS AND OPPORTUNITIES: WOMEN LEADERS

1. In general, there are fewer women than men in elected political positions. In your view, what are the main reasons for this?

2. After they are elected, do women have the same opportunities as men to take on positions of political leadership (e.g., as party leaders, parliamentary committee presidents, or cabinet ministers)?

If not, what are the main reasons for this, in your view?

3. When women are appointed to leadership positions, what types of issues are women given responsibility for?

4. Based on what you have observed, are women taken seriously as political leaders?

How do their experiences compare to those of men?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be taken seriously?

VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN IN POLITICS

1. Based on what you have observed, is it common for women candidates to face violence, intimidation, or harassment on the campaign trail?

If so, what do these attacks look like? Consider adding questions from the women politician survey.

Who are the main perpetrators?

Do these attacks affect women's ability to be elected?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?

2. Based on what you have observed, is it common for women leaders to face violence, intimidation, or harassment for their political work?

If so, what do these attacks look like?

Who are the main perpetrators?

Do these attacks affect women's ability to exercise their political functions?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. What kinds of policies or strategies do you think are needed to advance women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria? These could include actions by the government, political parties, or civil society, for example.

KEY INFORMANT INTERVIEW GUIDE: WOMEN POLITICIANS

CONSENT

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is _____ [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague _____ [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion. We work for the Cloudburst Assessment Team and we have been commissioned by USAID to conduct an assessment of women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria.

The purpose of our discussion today is to hear about your experiences and views on barriers and opportunities for women in politics. The Cloudburst Group is a non-political research organization, and we are not related to the government or any political parties. We are completely neutral on all of the issues we'll be talking about; we're just here to learn about your experiences.

Our discussion should take approximately 60 minutes, but if your time is more limited, I can prioritize my questions [sample priority questions marked in bold]. Your participation does not involve any risks other than what you would encounter in daily life. Your participation is entirely voluntary and you can choose not to answer a question or leave the discussion at any time without providing a reason.

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If you have any questions you may ask them now or later, even after the discussion has started.

[START THE RECORDING TO GET VERBAL CONSENT]

Do you agree to participate in this discussion today? Yes No

[IF THE RESPONDENTS SAY "YES," CONTINUE DISCUSSION]

****Administer the questionnaire before starting the KII**

BARRIERS AND OPPORTUNITIES: WOMEN CANDIDATES

- 1. Many countries around the world have introduced gender quotas for candidates. What impact have quotas had on the number of women standing as candidates in Nigeria?**

Did quotas play a role in your own nomination?

Do you support quotas as a measure to promote women in politics?

What kinds of women tend to benefit from quotas in Nigeria?

2. **Does your party provide any financial support to its candidates?**
If so, what is the nature of this support?
Is this support distributed evenly across candidates?
If not, what are the determinants of party support for particular candidates?
3. **Did you have to raise any of your own funds for your political campaign?**
If so, how did the amount of these funds compare to what you received from your party?
What kinds of actors donated to your campaign?
Do you think, in general, it is more difficult for women than men to raise campaign funding?
Please explain.
4. **Does your party help candidates with their campaigns in any other ways?**
If so, what does the party offer in the way of support?
Is this support distributed evenly across candidates?
If not, what are the determinants of party support for particular candidates?
Do parties place women in electable districts or list positions?
5. **What is the media environment like for women candidates?**
Do women candidates receive the same level of media coverage as male candidates?
Are women candidates treated differently than men in terms of the substance of media coverage?
6. **Who are the male allies to WPPL in your party?**

BARRIERS AND OPPORTUNITIES: WOMEN LEADERS

1. **In general, there are fewer women than men in elected political positions. In your view, what are the main reasons for this?**
2. **After they are elected, do women have the same opportunities as men to take on positions of political leadership (e.g., as party leaders, parliamentary committee chairmen, or cabinet ministers)?**
If not, what are the main reasons for this, in your view?
3. **When women are appointed to leadership positions, what types of issues are women given responsibility for?**
4. **Are there any forms of institutional support for women after they have been elected? Examples might be training, mentorship, or staff.**
If so, are these different in any ways from the forms of institutional support available to men?
Are these provided through formal channels, like parliaments or political parties, or just informally?

5. Is there a women's caucus in the Senate/House of Representatives?

If so, what is its main role?

Have you been involved in its activities?

What type of issues does this caucus promote (social, economic, budget, etc.)?

How effective has it been in advancing gender equality?

6. Based on what you have observed, are women taken seriously as political leaders?

How do their experiences compare to those of men?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be taken seriously?

VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN IN POLITICS

Have you ever experienced any violence when participating in politics

1. Have you ever experienced any of the following behaviors when trying to participate in politics?

1. Someone hit or beat you or assaulted you physically in some other way
2. Someone prevented you from leaving the house
3. Someone made threats against you and/or your family
4. Someone tried to have sex with you without your consent
5. Someone made unwanted sexual advances toward you
6. Someone attempted to destroy your property
7. Someone attempted to destroy your livelihood
8. Someone harassed you online
9. Someone hacked your email or social media accounts
10. Someone spread "fake news" about you that was sexual in nature
11. Someone spread "fake news" about you that was gendered in nature
12. Someone tried to kill you

If so, who were the main perpetrators of these acts?

How did experiencing these acts affect your willingness to participate in politics?

2. Have you ever witnessed other women being targeted for trying to participate in politics?

1. Someone tried to kill her
2. Someone hit or beat her or assaulted her physically in some other way
3. Someone prevented her from leaving the house
4. Someone made threats against her and/or her family
5. Someone tried to have sex with her
6. Someone made unwanted sexual advances toward her
7. Someone attempted to destroy her property

8. Someone attempted to destroy her livelihood
9. Someone harassed her online
10. Someone hacked her email or social media accounts
11. Someone spread “fake news” about her that was sexual in nature
12. Someone spread “fake news” about her that was gendered in nature

If so, who were the main perpetrators of these acts?

How did experiencing these acts affect their willingness to participate in politics?

3. **Based on what you have observed, is it common for women candidates to face violence, intimidation, or harassment on the campaign trail?**

If so, what do these attacks look like?

Who are the main perpetrators?

Do these attacks affect women’s ability to be elected?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?

4. **Based on what you have observed, is it common for women leaders to face violence, intimidation, or harassment for their political work?**

If so, what do these attacks look like?

Who are the main perpetrators?

Do these attacks affect women’s ability to exercise their political functions?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. **What kinds of policies or strategies do you think are needed to advance women’s political participation and leadership in Nigeria? These could include actions by the government, political parties, or civil society, for example.**
2. **What support do women in politics need (training, skills, resources) to be able to inform local/national government policy?**

KEY INFORMANT INTERVIEW GUIDE: TRADITIONAL LEADERS

CONSENT

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is _____ [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague _____ [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion. We work for the Cloudburst Assessment Team and we have been commissioned by USAID to conduct an assessment of women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria.

The purpose of our discussion today is to hear about your experiences and views on barriers and opportunities for women in politics. The Cloudburst Group is a non-political research organization, and we are not related to the government or any political parties. We are completely neutral on all of the issues we'll be talking about; we're just here to learn about your experiences.

Our discussion should take approximately 60 minutes, but if your time is more limited, I can prioritize my questions [sample priority questions marked in bold]. Your participation does not involve any risks other than what you would encounter in daily life. Your participation is entirely voluntary and you can choose not to answer a question or leave the discussion at any time without providing a reason.

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If you have any questions you may ask them now or later, even after the discussion has started.

[START THE RECORDING TO GET VERBAL CONSENT]

Do you agree to participate in this discussion today? Yes No

[IF THE RESPONDENTS SAY "YES," CONTINUE DISCUSSION]

****Administer the questionnaire before starting the KII**

BARRIERS AND OPPORTUNITIES:

1. **In general, there are fewer women than men in politics. In your view, as a Traditional leader what are the main reasons for this?**
2. **Are there any specific traditional or cultural practices or norms or traditionally expected gender roles that you believe either encourage or discourage women's political participation? Could you elaborate on them?**

3. **Does your traditional institution provide any support when a member indicates interest in participating in politics?**

If so, what is the nature of this support?

Is this support distributed evenly across candidates?

If not, what are the determinants of traditional institutions support for particular candidates?

4. **Does your traditional institution (emirate) help candidates with their campaigns in any other ways?**

If so, what does the party offer during campaigns as a way of support?

Is this support distributed evenly across candidates?

If not, what are the determinants of party support for particular candidates during campaigns?

5. **Based on what you have observed, are women taken seriously as political leaders by members of your community?**

How do their experiences compare to those of men?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be taken seriously?

VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN IN POLITICS

1. **Based on what you have observed, is it common for women candidates to face violence, intimidation, or harassment on the campaign trail or during elections?**

If so, what do these attacks look like?

Who are the main perpetrators?

Do these attacks affect women's ability to be elected?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. **What kinds of policies or strategies do you think are needed to advance women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria?**

KEY INFORMANT INTERVIEW GUIDE: RELIGIOUS LEADERS

CONSENT

Thank you very much for meeting with us today. My name is _____ [MODERATOR NAME] and this is my colleague _____ [ASSISTANT NAME] who will be taking notes throughout our discussion. We work for the Cloudburst Assessment Team and we have been commissioned by USAID to conduct an assessment of women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria.

The purpose of our discussion today is to hear about your experiences and views on barriers and opportunities for women in politics. The Cloudburst Group is a non-political research organization, and we are not related to the government or any political parties. We are completely neutral on all of the issues we'll be talking about; we're just here to learn about your experiences.

Our discussion should take approximately 60 minutes, but if your time is more limited, I can prioritize my questions [sample priority questions marked in bold]. Your participation does not involve any risks other than what you would encounter in daily life. Your participation is entirely voluntary and you can choose not to answer a question or leave the discussion at any time without providing a reason.

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If you have any questions you may ask them now or later, even after the discussion has started.

[START THE RECORDING TO GET VERBAL CONSENT]

Do you agree to participate in this discussion today? Yes No

[IF THE RESPONDENTS SAY "YES," CONTINUE DISCUSSION]

****Administer the questionnaire before starting the KII**

BARRIERS AND OPPORTUNITIES:

1. **In general, there are fewer women than men in politics. In your view, as a religious leader what are the main reasons for this?**
2. **Are there any specific religious teachings or doctrines that you believe either encourage or discourage women's political participation? Could you elaborate on them?**

3. **Does your religious institution (church or mosque) provide any support when a member indicates interest to participate in politics?**

If so, what is the nature of this support?

Is this support distributed evenly across candidates?

If not, what are the determinants of religious institutions support for particular candidates?

4. **Does your religious institution (church or mosque) help candidates with their campaigns in any other ways?**

If so, what does the party offer during campaigns as a way of support?

Is this support distributed evenly across candidates?

If not, what are the determinants of party support for particular candidates during campaigns?

5. **Based on what you have observed, are women taken seriously as political leaders by members of your faith?**

How do their experiences compare to those of men?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be taken seriously?

VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN IN POLITICS

1. **Based on what you have observed, is it common for women candidates to face violence, intimidation, or harassment on the campaign trail?**

If so, what do these attacks look like?

Who are the main perpetrators?

Do these attacks affect women's ability to be elected?

Are some types of women more likely than others to be targeted?

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. **What kinds of policies or strategies do you think are needed to advance women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria?**

POLITICIAN SURVEY: MEN'S VERSION

CONSENT

This survey is being administered by The Cloudburst Group's assessment team assessing women's political participation in leadership in Nigeria. We do not represent the government or a political party.

Purpose of study

We are gathering information about the experiences of elected officials in Nigeria, as well as their views regarding women's political participation and leadership. This study will be used to help inform the United States Agency for International Development (USAID) programs related to these topics in Nigeria.

Description of the study procedures

If you agree to be in this study, you will be asked to answer survey questions about your experiences, your household, politics, civic engagement, and other topics. The survey will take approximately 30 minutes to complete ONLINE.

Risks/discomforts of participating in this study

Your participation in this study does not involve any risks other than what you would encounter in daily life. You may be uncomfortable with some of the questions and topics we will ask about. If you are uncomfortable, you are free to not answer or to skip to the next question.

Benefits of participating in the study

Your participation is important to help us and USAID learn more about the experiences of elected officials in Nigeria.

Confidentiality

Your responses to this survey will be kept strictly confidential. We will report all results as averages. We will never share any information that could be used to identify you outside of the research team. As such, no one will know whether you participated in the survey or which answers are yours. Since no one will know which answers are yours, we ask that you answer all questions honestly.

Right to refuse or withdraw

The decision to participate in this study is entirely up to you. You may refuse to take part in the study at any time. You have the right not to answer any single question, as well as to withdraw completely from the study at any point during the process; additionally, you have the right to request that the research team delete your answers. There are no penalties for refusing or withdrawing.

Right to ask questions and report concerns

You have the right to ask questions about this research study and to have those questions answered before, during, or after the research.

Consent. Do you agree to participate in this survey?

1. Yes
2. No

INTRODUCTION

This survey seeks to gather the views of men in politics with regard to women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria.

BACKGROUND

1. What is your current political position?

- State Governor/Deputy Governor
- Federal Member of Parliament (Senator, House of Representatives member)
- State Member of Parliament
- Local government area chairman/member of local government council
- Political party representative (if not in the elected bodies)
- Civic activist
- Other (specify) _____

2. What is your political party?

- All Progressives Congress
- People's Democratic Party
- Labour Party
- New Nigeria People's Party
- All Progressives Grand Alliance
- Social Democratic Party
- Young Progressives Party
- Other political party (specify) _____

3. What is your age?

- 20 or younger than 20
- 21–30
- 31–40
- 41–50
- 51–60
- 61+

4. What is your state of origin?

5. In what state do you work?

6. What is your religion?

- Islam
- Christianity
- Other (specify) _____

POLITICAL EXPERIENCE

1. How many years have you been active in politics?

- 1 year or less
- 2–4 years
- 5–7 years
- 8–10 years
- 11 + years

2. Have you ever run as a candidate in elections?

- Yes
- No

2a. If so, which political offices have you contested? (Select all that apply)

- State Governor/Deputy Governor
- Federal Member of Parliament (Senator, House of Representatives member)
- State Member of Parliament
- Local government area chairman/member of local government council
- Leader of political party
- Other (specify) _____

3. Have you ever held a formal leadership position in politics?

- Yes
- No

3a. If so, what leadership positions have you held? (Select all that apply)

- State Governor/Deputy Governor
- Federal Member or speaker of Parliament (Senator, House of Representatives member)
- State Member of Parliament
- Local government area chairman/member of local government council
- Leader of political party
- Other (specify) _____

4. What was your motivation for getting involved in politics? (Select up to three options)

- Opportunity to participate in solving social problems.
- Opportunity to contribute to economic development or national security.
- Opportunity to raise issues of family, community, education, health, nutrition, culture, etc.
- Opportunity to fight corruption and manage resources more effectively.
- Community/political party proposed me to run in (local) elections.
- Opportunity to take advantage of the 30 percent quota for women.
- Opportunity to build own political career.
- Opportunity to demonstrate efficient and decent work as a politician.
- Other (specify) _____

5. Does your party provide any financial support to its candidates?

- Yes
- No

5a. If so, what is the nature of this support?

- Financing the organization of activities of the electoral headquarters
- Financing the production and dissemination of promotional products
- Logistics costs of organization of meetings with voters
- Other (specify) _____
- Not sure

6. Is this support distributed evenly across candidates?

- Yes
- No

6a. If not, what are the determinants of party support for particular candidates?

- Number in party electoral lists
- Candidate's social status and network
- Candidate's financial contributions
- Popularity among the population
- Candidate's gender
- Other (specify) _____

WOMEN'S LEADERSHIP OPPORTUNITIES

1. In general, there are fewer women than men in elected political positions. In your view, what are the main reasons for this? (Select up to three options)

- Lack of support of family members and close associates
- Negative attitude of society, gender stereotypes
- Women lack political networks.
- Women have lower education.
- Women have lower self-confidence.
- Women are overloaded with household chores.
- Professional, job responsibilities
- Lack of funding
- Threat of violence to women who engage in politics.
- Open opposition from male politicians and other public leaders
- Open opposition from female politicians and other public leaders
- Other (specify) _____
- Not sure

2. Does your party have any measures in place to recruit women as candidates?

- Yes
- No (skip to Q17)

2a. If so, what are these measures?

- Actively recruit prominent women, civic activists, and civil servants to join the political party.
- Engage female youth in the activities of political party and organizational development.
- Introduce more female candidates in the electoral lists of the party than what is required by law.
- Other (specify) _____
- Not sure

3. Have these measures led to an increase in the number of women standing as candidates?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

4. Do you support such measures to increase the number of women in elected positions?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

5. Do women have the same opportunities as men to take on positions of political leadership (for example, as party leaders, parliamentary committee chairs, or cabinet ministers)?

- Yes (skip to Q18)
- No
- Not sure

5a. If not, what are the main reasons for this, in your view?

- _____

6. When women are appointed to leadership positions, what types of issues are women given responsibility for? (Select up to two options)

- Social issues related to childcare, health, and education
- Economic development
- Crime
- State security
- Equal rights and opportunities, social inclusion
- Other (specify) _____

7. Is there a women's wing in your political party?

- Yes
- No (skip to Q20)
- Not sure (skip to Q20)

7a. If so, what is the main role of the women's wing? (select up to two)

- Focus of party support for gender equality and equity.
- Forum for dialogue between female party members with different ideologies
- Venue to provide mentoring and support to female party members and candidates.
- Promote positive public view of the party's inclusive position.
- Other (specify) _____

8. Do you see a value in creating a women's wing in political parties?

- Yes
- No (skip to Q21)
- Not sure (skip to Q21)

8a. If so, what would you envision as the role of the women's wing in the political party?

- Focus of party support for gender equality and equity.
- Forum for dialogue between female party members with different ideologies
- Venue to provide mentoring and support to female party members and candidates.
- Promote positive public view of the party's inclusive position.
- Other (specify) _____

9. Are women represented in the party's executive committee?

- Yes
- No (skip to Q22)
- Not sure (skip to Q22)

9a. If so, what kinds of positions do they hold? (select all that apply)

- Head
- Deputy head
- Member
- Technical staff
- Administrative/secretarial
- Other (specify) _____

VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN IN POLITICS

1. Do women candidates face violence, intimidation, or harassment on the campaign trail?

- Yes
- No (skip to Q28)
- Not sure

1a. If so, what does this intimidation look like? (Select all that apply)

- Unequal distribution of party resources, including financing and human resources
- Unfair distribution of electoral districts
- Minimize exposure to voters (order of speeches, advertisements, promotion by party spokespeople, selection of venues that are not voter friendly)
- Request to sign a declaration of refusal to receive a deputy's mandate.
- Requirements that women candidates perform party work beyond their agreed-upon role in the elections
- Shouting or bullying during a public speech by a female candidate
- Other (specify)

2. Who are the main perpetrators? (Select all that apply)

- Head of the party's campaign headquarter
- Head of party
- Male candidates from the same party
- Male candidates from other parties
- Voters
- Representatives of electoral commissions
- Law enforcement bodies

- Other (specify)
- Not sure

3. Do these attacks affect women's ability to be elected?

- Yes
- No (skip to Q28)
- Not sure

4. Are existing laws sufficient for addressing violence, intimidation, and harassment of women on the campaign trail?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

5. Does your party have any policy in place to deal with this problem?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

5a. If so, is this policy enforced?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

6. Are other measures needed to address this problem?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

6a. If so, who should be responsible for stopping these acts and holding perpetrators accountable? (Select up to three)

- National Electoral Committee
- Law enforcement bodies
- Local government
- Courts
- Presidential administration/government
- Electoral bodies
- National Parliament
- Civil society
- International organizations
- Other (specify) _____
- Not sure

IMPACT OF WOMEN IN POLITICS

I. Do men and women have equal voices and influence in political debates in Nigeria?

- Yes
- No
- Don't know
- Other (specify)
- Not sure

2. Are men and women equally effective as leaders in Nigeria?

- Yes
- No
- Don't know
- Other (specify)

POLITICIAN SURVEY: WOMEN'S VERSION

CONSENT

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Purpose of study

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If you agree to be in this study, you will be asked to answer survey questions about your experiences, your household, politics, civic engagement, and other topics. The survey will take approximately 30–45 minutes to complete ONLINE.

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Right to ask questions and report concerns

You have the right to ask questions about this research study and to have those questions answered before, during, or after the research.

Consent.

Do you agree to participate in this survey?

1. Yes
2. No

INTRODUCTION

This survey seeks to gather the views of women in politics with regard to women's political participation and leadership in Nigeria. The survey should take 30–45 minutes to complete.

BACKGROUND

1. What is your current political position?

- State Governor/Deputy Governor
- Federal Member of Parliament (Senator, House of Representatives member)
- State Member of Parliament
- Local government area chairman/member of local government council
- Political party representative (if not in the elected bodies)
- Civic activist
- Other (specify) _____

2. What is your political party?

- All Progressives Congress
- People's Democratic Party
- Labour Party
- New Nigeria People's Party
- All Progressives Grand Alliance
- Social Democratic Party
- Young Progressives Party
- Other political party (specify) _____

3. What is your age?

- 20 or younger than 20
- 21–30
- 31–40
- 41–50
- 51–60
- 61+

4. What is your state of origin? _____

5. In what state do you work? _____

6. What is your religion?

- Islam
- Christianity
- Other (specify) _____

POLITICAL EXPERIENCE

1. How many years have you been active in politics?

- 1 year or less
- 2–4 years
- 5–7 years
- 8–10 years
- 11 + years

2. Have you ever run as a candidate in elections?

- Yes
- No

2a. If so, which political offices have you contested? (Select all that apply)

- State Governor/Deputy Governor
- Federal Member of Parliament (Senator, House of Representatives member)
- State Member of Parliament
- Local government area chairman/member of local government council
- Leader of political party
- Other (specify) _____

3. Have you ever held a formal leadership position in politics?

- Yes
- No

3a. If so, what leadership positions have you held? (Select all that apply)

- State Governor/Deputy Governor
- Federal Member or speaker of Parliament (Senator, House of Representatives member)
- State Member of Parliament
- Local government area chairman/member of local government council
- Leader of political party
- Other (specify) _____

4. What was your motivation for getting involved in politics? (Select up to three options)

- Opportunity to participate in solving social problems
- Opportunity to contribute to economic development or national security
- Opportunity to raise issues of family, community, education, health, nutrition, culture, etc.
- Opportunity to fight corruption and manage resources more effectively
- Community/political party proposed that I run in (local) elections.
- Opportunity to take advantage of the 30 percent quota for women
- Opportunity to build own political career
- Opportunity to demonstrate efficient and decent work as a politician.
- Other (specify) _____

5. Does your party provide any financial support to its candidates?

- Yes
- No

5a. If so, what is the nature of this support?

- Financing the organization of activities of the electoral headquarters
- Financing the production and dissemination of election promotional materials and adverts
- Logistics costs of organization of meetings with voters
- Other (specify) _____
- Not sure

6. Is this support distributed evenly across candidates?

- Yes
- No

6a. If not, what are the determinants of party support for particular candidates?

- Number in party electoral lists
- Candidate's social status and network
- Candidate's financial contributions
- Popularity among the population
- Candidate's gender
- Other (specify) _____

WOMEN'S LEADERSHIP OPPORTUNITIES

1. In general, there are fewer women than men in elected political positions. In your view, what are the main reasons for this? (Select up to three options)

- Lack of support of family members and close associates
- Negative attitude of society, gender stereotypes
- Women lack political networks
- Women have lower education
- Women have lower self-confidence
- Women are overloaded with household chores
- Professional, job responsibilities
- Lack of funding
- Threat of violence to women who engage in politics
- Open opposition from male politicians and other public leaders
- Open opposition from female politicians and other public leaders
- Other (specify) _____
- Not sure

2. Does your party have any measures in place to recruit women as candidates?

- Yes
- No (skip to Q17)

2a. If so, what are these measures?

- Actively recruit prominent women, civic activists, and civil servants to join the political party
- Engage female youth in the activities of political party and organizational development
- Introduce more female candidates in the electoral lists of the party than what is required by law
- Other (specify) _____
- Not sure

3. Have these measures led to an increase in the number of women standing as candidates?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure _____

4. Do you support such measures to increase the number of women in elected positions?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure _____

5. Do women have the same opportunities as men to take on positions of political leadership (for example, as party leaders, parliamentary committee chairs, or cabinet ministers)?

- Yes (skip to Q18)
- No
- Not sure _____

5a. If not, what are the main reasons for this, in your view?

- _____

6. When women are appointed to leadership positions, what types of issues are women given responsibility for? (Select up to two options)

- Social issues related to child care, health, and education
- Economic development
- Crime
- State security
- Equal rights and opportunities, social inclusion
- Other (specify) _____

7. Is there a women's wing in your political party?

- Yes
- No (skip to Q20)
- Not sure (skip to Q20)

7a. If so, what is the main role of the women's wing? (Select up to two options)

- Focus of party support for gender equality and equity
- Forum for dialogue between female party members with different ideologies
- Venue to provide mentoring and support to female party members and candidates
- Promote positive public view of the party's inclusive position
- Other (specify) _____

8. Do you see a value in creating a women's wing in political parties?

- Yes
- No (skip to Q21)
- Not sure (skip to Q21)

8a. If so, what would you envision as the role of the women's wing in the political party?

- Focus of party support for gender equality and equity.
- Forum for dialogue between female party members with different ideologies
- Venue to provide mentoring and support to female party members and candidates
- Promote positive public view of the party's inclusive position
- Other (specify) _____

9. Are women represented in the party's executive committee?

- Yes
- No (skip to Q22)
- Not sure (skip to Q22)

9a. If so, what kinds of positions do they hold? (select all that apply)

- Head
- Deputy head
- Member
- Technical staff
- Administrative/secretarial
- Other (specify) _____

PERSONAL EXPERIENCES

Please provide a response to the following questions as they relate to your personal experience participating in politics.

	FREQUENTLY	SOMETIMES	RARELY	ONCE	NEVER	DECLINE TO RESPOND	10A. IF SO, WHO WERE THE MAIN PERPETRATORS OF THESE ACTS?*** (PUT THE RELEVANT LETTER)
Someone hit or beat you or assaulted you physically in some other way							
Someone prevented you from leaving the house							
Someone made threats against you and/or your family							
Someone tried to assault you							
Someone made unwanted sexual advances toward you							

	FREQUENTLY	SOMETIMES	RARELY	ONCE	NEVER	DECLINE TO RESPOND	10A. IF SO, WHO WERE THE MAIN PERPETRATORS OF THESE ACTS?*** (PUT THE RELEVANT LETTER)
Someone attempted to destroy your property							
Someone attempted to destroy your livelihood							
Someone harassed you online							
Someone hacked your email or social media accounts							
Someone spread “fake news” about you that was sexual in nature							
Someone spread “fake news” about you that was gendered in nature							

- Party leader
- Male member of the same party I belong to
- Female member of the same party I belong to
- Male member of another party
- Female member of another party
- Male colleague (person with whom I work in the same organization)
- Female colleague (person with whom I work in the same organization)
- Unknown person, stranger
- Husband
- Father or brother
- Other members of my family
- Male neighbors
- Female neighbors
- Other (specify) _____

Has anyone threatened or tried to kill you when you were trying to participate in politics?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

**1. How did experiencing these acts affect your willingness to participate in politics?
(Select all that apply)**

- I try to defend myself via legal procedures
- I try not to pay attention to such aggression
- Such violence demotivates me to participate in politics
- Such violence forces me to unite with other politicians who share my beliefs in order to effectively confront aggression
- Such violence motivates me to work actively to remove the systemic barriers and causes that make such violence and aggression possible
- Other (specify) _____
- Not sure

2. Have you witnessed other women being targeted for participating or trying to participate in politics?

	FREQUENTLY	SOMETIMES	RARELY	ONCE	NEVER	DECLINE TO RESPOND	24A. IF SO, WHO WERE THE MAIN PERPETRATORS OF THESE ACTS?**** (PUT THE RELEVANT LETTER)
Someone hit or beat her or assaulted her physically in some other way							
Someone prevented her from leaving the house							
Someone made threats against her and/or her family							
Someone tried to rape her							
Someone made unwanted sexual advances toward her							
Someone attempted to destroy her property							

	FREQUENTLY	SOMETIMES	RARELY	ONCE	NEVER	DECLINE TO RESPOND	24A. IF SO, WHO WERE THE MAIN PERPETRATORS OF THESE ACTS?**** (PUT THE RELEVANT LETTER)
Someone attempted to destroy her livelihood							
Someone harassed her online							
Someone hacked her email or social media accounts							
Someone spread “fake news” about her that was sexual in nature							
Someone spread “fake news” about her that was gendered in nature							
Someone tried to kill her							

- Party leader
- Male member of the same party I belong to
- Female member of the same party I belong to
- Male member of opposite party
- Female member of opposite party
- Male colleague (person with whom I work in the same organization)
- Female colleague (person with whom I work in the same organization)
- Unknown person, stranger
- Husband
- Father or brother
- Other members of my family
- Male neighbors
- Female neighbors
- Other (specify) _____

**I. How did experiencing these acts affect their willingness to participate in politics?
(Select all that apply)**

- It demotivated or stopped her/them from participating in politics
- It motivated her/them to directly confront the aggressor(s)
- It motivated her/them to work actively to remove the systemic causes that make such violence and aggression possible
- Other (specify) _____
- Not sure

VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN IN POLITICS

I. Do women candidates face violence, intimidation, or harassment on the campaign trail?

- Yes
- No (skip to Q32)
- Not sure

I a. If so, what does this intimidation look like? (Select all that apply)

- Unequal distribution of party resources, including financing and human resources
- Unfair distribution of electoral districts
- Minimized exposure to voters (order of speeches, advertisements, promotion by party spokespeople, selection of venues that are not voter friendly)
- Requesting to sign a declaration of refusal to receive a deputy's mandate
- Requirements that women candidates perform party work beyond their agreed-upon role in the elections
- Shouting or bullying during a public speech by a female candidate
- Other (specify)

2. Who are the main perpetrators? (Select all that apply)

- Head of the party's campaign headquarters
- Head of party
- Male candidates from the same party
- Male candidates from other parties
- Voters
- Representatives of electoral commissions
- Law enforcement bodies
- Other (specify)
- Not sure

3. Do these attacks affect women's ability to be elected?

- Yes
- No (skip to Q32)
- Not sure

4. Are existing laws sufficient for addressing violence, intimidation, and harassment of women on the campaign trail?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

5. Does your party have any policy in place to deal with this problem?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

5a. If so, is this policy enforced?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

6. Are other measures needed to address this problem?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

*6a. If so, who should be responsible for stopping these acts and holding perpetrators accountable?
(Select up to three)*

- National Electoral Committee
- Law enforcement bodies
- Local government
- Courts
- Presidential administration/government
- Electoral bodies
- National Parliament
- Civil society
- International organizations
- Other (specify) _____
- Not sure

IMPACT OF WOMEN IN POLITICS

1. Do men and women have equal voices and influence in political debates in Nigeria?

- Yes
- No
- Don't know
- Other (specify)
- Not sure

2. Are men and women equally effective as leaders in Nigeria?

- Yes
- No
- Don't know
- Other (specify)